China Unfold

A deeper journey.

The illustrated China travel reference. Places, people and practical details for a journey that feels like you.

EDITORIAL DRAFT - NOT FOR SALE

A country to discover.

Begin with a place that speaks to you. These chapters are introductions, with practical prompts to help you plan more deeply.

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A country to discover.

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A little preparation.

Check entry requirements

Confirm requirements for your passport, route and stay with the official authorities before buying non-refundable travel. Hong Kong and Macao have separate entry arrangements.

Official reference

Keep the arrival details offline

Save your accommodation address in Chinese, reservation confirmations, first transfer, insurance details and emergency contacts. Carry more than one way to pay.

Official reference

Think door to door

Check the exact station and airport on each ticket. Leave time for local transfers, security, check-in and rest. A train journey is only one part of a travel day.

Official reference

Travel thoughtfully

Ask before photographing people. Follow local guidance at temples and museums. For food allergies, carry a carefully translated explanation and confirm ingredients directly.

This reference is an editorial planning draft. Opening hours, prices, transport schedules and reservations require current verification. Read linked sources before committing to bookings.

Beijing

Beijing / North

Imperial stories, lived one hutong at a time.

Beijing rewards a neighbourhood-by-neighbourhood approach. Imperial courtyards occupy enormous blocks; the quieter pleasures are in hutong lanes, lakeside paths and breakfast shops between them. Keep the Great Wall on a separate day and resist crossing the city for every meal.

SUGGESTED STAY 4-5 days

WHEN TO GO April-May · September-October

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BEIJING

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Temple of Heaven

Beijing / Beijing

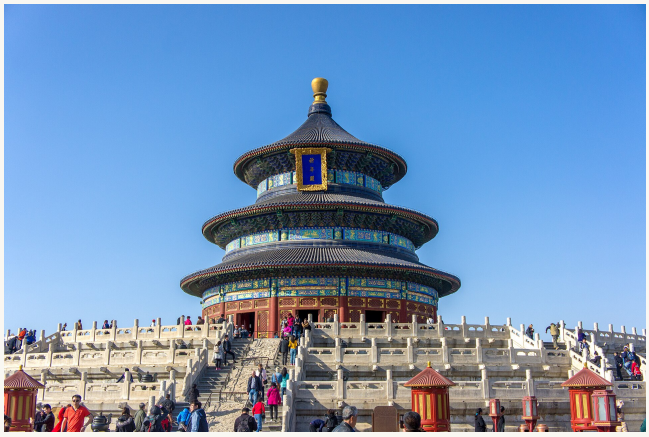

Photo: Shujianyang | CC BY-SA 4.0

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A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Forbidden City

Give the palace a full morning and leave time for the galleries, not just the central axis.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Temple of Heaven

Walk through the park before exploring the ceremonial architecture.

Find on map

03 / DEDICATED OUTING

Mutianyu Great Wall

Make this a separate day trip, with transport back to the city arranged in advance.

Find on map

BEIJING / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Summer Palace

Lakeside paths, painted corridors and palace gardens northwest of the centre. Give this an unhurried half-day; the grounds involve substantial walking.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Jingshan Park

Climb the central hill for a view over the Forbidden City roofs. A useful short stop after the palace, with steps to the viewpoint.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Beihai Park

A lake, white stupa and garden pavilions west of Jingshan. Choose it for a gentler park afternoon rather than another museum.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shichahai hutongs

Explore the lanes behind the lakes, then pause for tea. These remain residential streets: keep doorways clear and ask before photographing people.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

798 Art District

Former industrial buildings now house galleries and design shops. Browse a few exhibitions rather than expecting one single-ticket attraction.

Find on map

BEIJING

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Peking duck

Order roast duck with pancakes, scallions and sauce; a shared meal makes more sense than a quick solo snack.

WHAT TO EAT

Zhajiangmian

Wheat noodles with savoury bean sauce and vegetable toppings. A practical lunch between sights; meat is common in the sauce.

WHAT TO EAT

Beijing breakfast

Try sesame flatbreads or jianbing from a busy breakfast shop. Huguosi is a useful area to explore traditional snacks.

YOUR BASE

Wangfujing / Dongsi

Convenient for a first visit and eastern old-city sights; choose a hotel near a metro entrance rather than judging only distance on a map.

YOUR BASE

Gulou / Shichahai

Atmospheric lanes and evening walks, but some courtyard stays have difficult vehicle access and less soundproofing.

BEIJING

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Check whether your flight uses Capital or Daxing airport. Railway departures may use Beijing South, West, Chaoyang or another station: save the exact Chinese station name.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

The metro is useful for long hops; explore one hutong district on foot. Large roads and security queues make short map distances misleading.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Mutianyu, Badaling and the Ming Tombs are outside central Beijing. Choose one main excursion and confirm the return transfer before departure.

TIME WELL SPENT

Old-city day

Build around a confirmed Forbidden City reservation, followed by Jingshan. Leave the late afternoon free for nearby lanes rather than adding the Summer Palace.

TIME WELL SPENT

Extra days

Give the Temple of Heaven and a neighbourhood meal one day; the Summer Palace another half-day; reserve a separate day for your chosen Great Wall section.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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TravelChinaGuide · Food

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Shanghai

Shanghai / East

Old lanes, new horizons, and one remarkable river.

Shanghai is best read at street level before you look down from a tower. Move between the riverfront, tree-lined former concession streets and small local eating places. Pudong and the old city show very different faces; neither needs to be squeezed into a single skyline photograph.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO April-May · October-November

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SHANGHAI

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Shanghai Museum

Shanghai / Shanghai

Photo: Hanjiang 2009 (2009) | CC BY 2.0

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A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

The Bund

Walk the historic waterfront and return after dusk for a different view.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Former French Concession

Explore plane-tree streets, independent shops and the architecture around Wukang Road.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shanghai Museum

Choose a museum branch and check the exhibitions before setting aside a half-day.

Find on map

SHANGHAI / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yu Garden

A classical garden in the old city, surrounded by a busy bazaar. Separate time inside the garden from shopping and snacks outside.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shanghai Tower

An elevated view over Pudong and the Huangpu River. Choose a clear day; poor visibility can make a tower visit less rewarding.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Jade Buddha Temple

An active Buddhist temple with sculptural and architectural interest. Keep voices low and follow photography instructions inside halls.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Suzhou Creek

A riverside walk linking industrial heritage and newer cultural spaces. Pick a short section near your accommodation rather than attempting the whole waterfront.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Zhujiajiao

A water-town day trip with canals, bridges and narrow lanes. Leave time for the onward transfer from the metro and a relaxed return.

Find on map

SHANGHAI

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Xiaolongbao

Small steamed buns holding hot soup, usually pork-based. Let them cool and take a small bite before drinking the broth.

WHAT TO EAT

Shengjianbao

Pan-fried buns with crisp bases and juicy fillings. A filling breakfast or inexpensive lunch rather than a delicate dessert.

WHAT TO EAT

Benbang dishes

Shanghai home-style cooking often uses soy sauce and a little sweetness. Try red-braised pork with vegetables and rice as a shared meal.

YOUR BASE

People's Square / Jing'an

Central metro connections and a wide hotel range. Check whether the room faces a busy road.

YOUR BASE

Xuhui / former concession streets

Good for cafes and walking between meals; allow extra travel time for Pudong airport and attractions across the river.

SHANGHAI

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Pudong and Hongqiao are different airports. Hongqiao railway station connects with the airport complex, but terminal transfers still take time.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use the metro for cross-city travel and walk within individual neighbourhoods. A ferry can add a river-level perspective when its route suits your plans.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Zhujiajiao needs its own half-day or longer. Suzhou and Hangzhou work better as deliberately planned rail excursions than last-minute additions.

TIME WELL SPENT

Two contrasting days

Walk the Bund and old city on one day. On another, combine the former concession streets with a museum or gallery chosen for your interests.

TIME WELL SPENT

An extra day

Choose either a Pudong skyline visit in clear weather or a slower Zhujiajiao excursion. Do not plan both around a tightly timed airport departure.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Guilin

Guangxi / South

Let the river set the pace.

Think of this region as several bases rather than one city. Guilin has urban lakes and caves; Yangshuo has countryside lanes; Xingping has river scenery; Longji is a separate mountain excursion. Where you sleep changes how much of each day you spend in a vehicle.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO April-June · September-October

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GUILIN

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Yulong River

Guilin / Guangxi

Photo: Qeqertaq | CC BY 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING

Li River

Choose a river excursion for limestone peaks and changing reflections.

Find on map

02 / DEDICATED OUTING

Yulong River

Base yourself in Yangshuo for quiet rural lanes and river scenery.

Find on map

03 / DEDICATED OUTING

Xingping

Spend time along the riverside and explore beyond the busiest photo stop.

Find on map

GUILIN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Elephant Trunk Hill

The city landmark at the meeting of river and karst scenery. Pair it with a waterfront stroll rather than expecting a remote wilderness experience.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Reed Flute Cave

An illuminated limestone cave near Guilin. A useful weather alternative, with artificial lighting rather than an untouched cave expedition.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Two Rivers and Four Lakes

Lakeside paths and bridges make an easy urban walk. The evening atmosphere differs from the daytime gardens; a cruise is optional.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Longji Rice Terraces

A full-day trip or overnight stay from Guilin. Choose a village base and walking route before arranging transport; terraces change with the agricultural season.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Daxu Ancient Town

Old trading streets beside the Li River outside the centre. Combine a gentle lane walk with riverside time rather than treating it as a major hiking day.

Find on map

GUILIN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Guilin rice noodles

A breakfast staple with rice noodles, savoury toppings and pickles. Ask about meat and chilli before mixing everything together.

WHAT TO EAT

Yangshuo beer fish

Fish cooked in a beer-based sauce, commonly shared. Confirm fish size and the total price before ordering.

WHAT TO EAT

Oil tea

A savoury tea-based preparation associated with local communities. Try it alongside snacks; it is quite different from a pot of plain tea.

YOUR BASE

Central Guilin lakes

Practical for an arrival night, urban sightseeing and onward travel; it does not put you in the Yangshuo countryside.

YOUR BASE

Yangshuo / Yulong River

Town offers more dining choices; countryside stays offer quieter scenery but require planned transfers after dinner.

GUILIN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Check whether your ticket says Guilin, Guilin North or Guilin West. Yangshuo railway station is near Xingping, not beside Yangshuo town.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use walking for the central lakes and vehicles for separated sights. Around Yangshuo, choose short cycling routes suited to your experience and the road conditions.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Longji and Yangshuo lie in different directions from Guilin. River activities depend on weather and water conditions; keep an alternative land-based day.

TIME WELL SPENT

A regional introduction

Use an arrival afternoon for Guilin lakes. Move toward Yangshuo for a countryside day and choose one Li River experience rather than repeating similar cruises.

TIME WELL SPENT

With more time

Add Xingping at an unhurried pace, or spend a night at Longji. Avoid adding the terraces between two tightly scheduled transport connections.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Chengdu

Sichuan / Southwest

Good food. Long tea breaks. No need to rush.

Chengdu is a city of pauses: tea under trees, a bowl of noodles, then a museum or temple. Its famous excursions spread in several directions, so a comfortable visit balances neighbourhood time with one carefully chosen day trip. The food deserves its own place in the schedule.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · September-November

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CHENGDU

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Panda Research Base

Visit early and give the animals space; sightings and activity vary.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
People's Park

Order tea and watch everyday life unfold around the teahouses.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Wenshu Monastery

Pair the monastery with the surrounding lanes and a leisurely vegetarian meal.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Wuhou Shrine

Courtyards and memorial halls associated with the Three Kingdoms. Pair the visit with nearby Jinli, while keeping time for the historical exhibits.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Jinli Street

A lively, commercial lane of snacks and traditional-style architecture. Visit for atmosphere; compare prices before buying souvenirs.

Find on map

CHENGDU / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Du Fu Thatched Cottage

Gardens and buildings commemorating the Tang poet. A quieter cultural afternoon, especially for visitors who prefer parks to shopping streets.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Sanxingdui Museum

A full-day trip to Guanghan for striking ancient bronzes and archaeological displays. Plan the museum reservation and onward transfer together.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Dujiangyan

A full-day trip to the historic irrigation landscape. Bridges and waterworks involve walking; combining it with Qingcheng Mountain makes a much longer day.

Find on map

CHENGDU

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Mapo tofu

Silky tofu in a chilli-and-peppercorn sauce, often containing minced meat. Ask specifically if you need a meat-free version.

WHAT TO EAT

Dandan noodles

A small noodle dish with a punchy sauce. Useful for tasting alongside other snacks rather than ordering every dish as a full meal.

WHAT TO EAT

Sichuan hotpot

A social meal with ingredients cooked at the table. A divided broth can help a mixed group, but confirm each broth's ingredients.

YOUR BASE

Tianfu Square / Chunxi Road

Convenient for metro journeys and a broad hotel choice; larger shopping streets can remain busy late.

YOUR BASE

Wenshu / Qingyang

Good for temple visits and neighbourhood meals. Pick a stay near transport if you plan several excursions.

CHENGDU

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Tianfu and Shuangliu airports are separate. Check the terminal and allow ample time for Tianfu transfers; Chengdu East is a major high-speed rail hub.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

The metro works well between districts. Plan a short taxi or walking connection for places that are not beside a station.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

The panda base, Sanxingdui, Dujiangyan and Leshan are different outings. Reserve one major outlying attraction per day.

TIME WELL SPENT

City and pandas

Put the panda visit early in a day, then keep the afternoon flexible. Use a separate city day for Wenshu, People's Park and a leisurely Sichuan meal.

TIME WELL SPENT

Choose an excursion

Add Sanxingdui for archaeology or Dujiangyan for landscape and engineering. Retain an evening in Chengdu instead of stacking distant stops.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Xi'an

Shaanxi / Northwest

An ancient capital with stories beneath the surface.

Xi'an mixes monumental history with lively everyday streets. The walled centre is a useful walking base, but the Terracotta Army and several major museums lie well beyond it. Balance one large archaeological visit with time for noodles, calligraphy streets and the city wall.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · September-November

Photo: xiquinhosilva | CC BY 2.0

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XI'AN

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Giant Wild Goose Pagoda

Xi'an / Shaanxi

Photo: Alex Kwok | CC BY-SA 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING

Terracotta Army

Reserve a separate half-day or longer, allowing for travel outside the city.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Xi'an City Wall

Walk a section of the wall for a sense of the old city's scale.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Great Mosque

Explore the historic courtyard complex respectfully, then the surrounding food streets.

Find on map

XI'AN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shaanxi History Museum

An introduction to the region's dynasties through archaeological collections. Build your day around a confirmed reservation and the correct museum location.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Giant Wild Goose Pagoda

A Buddhist landmark south of the old city. Explore the surrounding squares at a different pace from the crowded evening pedestrian streets.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Small Wild Goose Pagoda and Xi'an Museum

A quieter pairing of historic grounds and museum collections. Check which areas are accessible before planning a pagoda climb.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Bell and Drum Towers

Landmarks in the old-city street grid. Seeing the exteriors and surrounding streets may suit a short visit better than entering both.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Huaqing Palace

An excursion in the Lintong area with imperial associations and landscaped grounds. Treat this as additional time near the Terracotta Army, not a quick city-centre stop.

Find on map

XI'AN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Roujiamo

Bread filled with chopped meat; pork and beef versions differ. Check the filling rather than assuming every stall serves the same recipe.

WHAT TO EAT

Yangrou paomo

Crumbled flatbread in mutton broth. A substantial meal, especially welcome on a cool day.

WHAT TO EAT

Liangpi

Cool noodles dressed with vinegar, chilli and other seasonings. Often paired with roujiamo for a simple lunch.

YOUR BASE

South Gate / inside the wall

Useful for evening walks and old-city meals. Check walking distance to a metro entrance.

YOUR BASE

Xiaozhai / pagoda district

Handy for southern museums and newer hotels, but less atmospheric if most evenings will be spent in the old city.

XI'AN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Xi'an Xianyang airport is outside the city. Xi'an North and the central Xi'an railway station are different; match the station to your ticket.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

The metro links major districts. Walk within the walled centre; wall access points and stairways determine where a walking or cycling visit starts.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

The Terracotta Army requires an out-of-town transfer. Huashan should be a separate mountain day with weather and return travel considered.

TIME WELL SPENT

Two history days

Use one day for the Terracotta Army. Spend another around the wall, Great Mosque area and a relaxed noodle meal.

TIME WELL SPENT

Extend the stay

Choose one major museum and the pagoda district on an extra day. Put Huashan on a separate date instead of adding it after a museum.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Hangzhou

Zhejiang / East

Tea-green hills and a lake worth slowing down for.

Hangzhou becomes more rewarding as you move away from a checklist of lake viewpoints. Allow time for western shore walks, a tea village and a temple, then explore the canal or old commercial streets. Hills, heat and weekend crowds affect the pace more than distances suggest.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · September-November

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HANGZHOU

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Leifeng Pagoda

Hangzhou / Zhejiang

Photo: David290 | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

West Lake

Choose one stretch of shoreline and its gardens rather than trying to circle everything.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Lingyin Temple

Allow time for the temple area and surrounding Buddhist stone carvings.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Longjing tea villages

Walk among tea-growing hills and ask clearly about prices before a tasting.

Find on map

HANGZHOU / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hefang Street

A busy old-style shopping street for snacks and small souvenirs. Use nearby lanes to break up the crowds and compare tea prices carefully.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Grand Canal and Gongchen Bridge

Canal-side walking and historic commercial neighbourhoods north of the lake. A different story of Hangzhou from its famous scenery.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Xixi Wetland

Waterways, vegetation and slower walking routes west of the centre. Reserve a half-day and check which walking or boat route your ticket covers.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Leifeng Pagoda

A prominent viewpoint on the south side of West Lake. Choose it for the perspective over the lake rather than as another obligatory tower.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

China National Tea Museum

Tea culture and growing traditions near the western hills. Check the branch address and combine it with one nearby tea-growing area.

Find on map

HANGZHOU

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Dongpo pork

Rich braised pork, usually shared with rice and vegetables. Order a small portion first if travelling as a couple.

WHAT TO EAT

Longjing shrimp

Shrimp associated with the city's famous green tea. A gentler-flavoured alternative to heavily seasoned dishes.

WHAT TO EAT

Osmanthus lotus root

Lotus root stuffed with glutinous rice and served sweet. A distinctive local dish to share rather than a savoury side.

YOUR BASE

East side of West Lake

Convenient for first visits, dining and city transport, but usually busier than the western shore.

YOUR BASE

West Lake hills / tea villages

Atmospheric for a slow stay; dining choice and evening transport can be more limited.

HANGZHOU

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Hangzhou East, Hangzhou station and Hangzhou West serve different rail journeys. Xiaoshan airport is another substantial transfer from the lake.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Walk selected lake sections rather than the whole perimeter. Use the metro for city districts and buses or taxis for hill-side destinations.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Tea villages, Lingyin and Xixi are spread out. Keep a flexible hill day for weather and avoid linking all three by repeated cross-city transfers.

TIME WELL SPENT

Lake and hills

Spend one day around a chosen West Lake shore and old streets. Give Lingyin and a nearby tea stop another day, allowing for queues and hill roads.

TIME WELL SPENT

A quieter extension

Explore the Grand Canal or Xixi on an extra day. Pick one landscape and spend time there instead of collecting multiple entrances.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Chongqing

Chongqing / Southwest

A city of rivers, stairs, and unexpected levels.

Chongqing is three-dimensional: a street on the map may sit far above the road beside it. Split your visit by peninsula and riverbank, and allow time for lifts, steps and viewpoints. Hotpot and the night riverfront are part of the experience, not rewards squeezed in after sightseeing.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · October-November

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CHONGQING

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Ciqikou

Chongqing / Chongqing

Photo: W457137120 | CC BY-SA 4.0

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A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hongyadong

View the illuminated riverside buildings from across the street or river.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shancheng lanes

Walk the hillside lanes to understand the city's layered geography.

Find on map

03 / DEDICATED OUTING

Dazu Rock Carvings

Make the carvings a separate excursion rather than a quick city stop.

Find on map

CHONGQING / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Three Gorges Museum

A useful introduction to the region and the Yangtze. Pair it with the People's Auditorium exterior nearby.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Ciqikou

A historic riverside district with busy souvenir and snack streets. Seek the quieter side lanes, but expect a commercial visitor area.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Liziba viewpoint

Watch a train pass through a building from the viewing area. A short photo stop rather than a full neighbourhood itinerary.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Eling Park

Hilltop greenery and city views. Allow for slopes and choose clear weather if the panorama is your main reason for visiting.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Wulong karst landscapes

A full-day trip or overnight excursion outside the urban core. Scenic-area transfers and walking take time; do not combine it with Dazu.

Find on map

CHONGQING

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Chongqing hotpot

A strongly flavoured communal meal, often with beef-fat broth. Confirm broth and ingredients if your group has dietary restrictions.

WHAT TO EAT

Xiaomian

Small bowls of noodles with chilli and peppercorn seasoning. Ask for a gentler version before the sauce is added.

WHAT TO EAT

Suanlafen

Sour-and-spicy noodles, commonly made from sweet-potato starch. Good for a casual snack stop; toppings can include meat.

YOUR BASE

Jiefangbei

A convenient first-time base for central sights and food, though traffic and busy streets can slow taxi pickups.

YOUR BASE

Guanyinqiao

A lively dining and shopping district across the river. Good metro access matters more than straight-line distance to attractions.

CHONGQING

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Jiangbei airport, Chongqing North, West and other railway stations are widely separated. Save the exact station and entrance shown on your ticket.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use rail transit between districts, then walk shorter routes. A map route may contain many stairs; ask hotels about step-free arrival.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Dazu and Wulong are separate full-day excursions. For a river cruise, confirm the actual boarding pier rather than navigating to a general waterfront.

TIME WELL SPENT

Urban contrasts

Pair the museum and auditorium with Eling or Liziba. Save a separate afternoon and evening for Jiefangbei, the lanes and riverfront lights.

TIME WELL SPENT

Beyond the city

Choose Dazu for carvings or Wulong for karst scenery. Leave a buffer night before an important onward connection.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Suzhou

Jiangsu / East

Gardens that turn a small space into a whole world.

Suzhou is more than a quick garden stop from Shanghai. Its best days move slowly between a garden, a canal lane and a noodle shop. Gardens can blur together if you visit too many at once; choose contrasting styles and keep a water-town excursion separate.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · September-November

Photo: Zhangzhugang | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

SUZHOU

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Lingering Garden

Suzhou / Jiangsu

Photo: | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Humble Administrator's Garden

Take your time with framed views, water and small architectural details.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Pingjiang Road

Explore the canal-side streets in the morning, then drift into smaller lanes.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Suzhou Museum

Combine the museum's architecture and collections with nearby historic neighbourhoods.

Find on map

SUZHOU / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Lingering Garden

A classical garden of framed views, rocks and connected courtyards. An alternative to adding several gardens near the museum in one morning.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Master of the Nets Garden

A compact garden that rewards close attention to proportions and reflections. A good choice when you want an intimate visit.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Tiger Hill

A hilltop pagoda and landscaped historic grounds northwest of the old centre. Expect steps and allow a half-day with travel.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shantang Street

Canal-side buildings and busy evening lanes. Walk beyond the first crowded stretch to find a less hurried rhythm.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Tongli

A water-town day trip with canals, bridges and garden courtyards. Leave time for the transfer between rail transit and the old town.

Find on map

SUZHOU

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Suzhou-style noodles

Fine noodles in clear or darker broth with separate toppings. Try a bowl early in the day when traditional noodle shops are active.

WHAT TO EAT

Squirrel-shaped mandarin fish

A fried whole fish with a sweet-sour sauce, usually best shared by several people.

WHAT TO EAT

Seasonal rice cakes

Local pastries and glutinous-rice sweets change through the year. Buy small portions to compare textures and sweetness.

YOUR BASE

Guanqian / Pingjiang area

Useful for old-city walks, gardens and food. Some lane-side hotels require a final walk with luggage.

YOUR BASE

Jinji Lake

More contemporary hotels and waterfront space; expect metro journeys back to the historic centre.

SUZHOU

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Suzhou station is convenient for the historic city; Suzhou North is a separate high-speed station. Nearby Shanghai airports require an additional transfer.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Combine the metro with walking within the old town. Garden entrances can be close on a map but separated by busy streets and queues.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Tongli and Zhouzhuang are separate water towns. Choose one and avoid trying to pair it with a full old-city garden day.

TIME WELL SPENT

Gardens without rushing

Visit the Humble Administrator's Garden and nearby museum if reservations align, then walk Pingjiang Road. Save another garden for the next day.

TIME WELL SPENT

A different perspective

Combine Tiger Hill and Shantang, or dedicate an extra day to Tongli. Keep time for a canal-side meal.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Zhangjiajie

Hunan / Central

Sandstone towers that change with every cloud.

Zhangjiajie is a collection of scenic areas, not a single mountain entrance. Wulingyuan is the useful base for the sandstone peaks; the urban centre serves Tianmen Mountain. Plan around your accommodation and entrance, and allow spare time when fog obscures the views.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO April-May · September-October

Photo: chensiyuan | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

ZHANGJIAJIE

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Tianzi Mountain

Zhangjiajie / Hunan

Photo: chensiyuan | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Wulingyuan

Allow two days for different parts of the forest park and its shuttle network.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Tianzi Mountain

Choose viewpoints according to weather and the park's daily operating arrangements.

Find on map

03 / DEDICATED OUTING

Tianmen Mountain

Treat this as a separate outing near Zhangjiajie city, not inside Wulingyuan.

Find on map

ZHANGJIAJIE / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yuanjiajie

A plateau of sandstone-pillar viewpoints inside the forest park. Combine it with nearby park transport, not an unrelated city attraction.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Golden Whip Stream

A valley walk beneath tall rock formations. A useful lower-level contrast to the high viewpoints, with walking distance tailored to your energy.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Huangshi Village

A forest-park plateau with panoramic paths. Choose it as an alternative park sector rather than attempting every summit area in a day.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Zhangjiajie Grand Canyon

A separate day trip from the forest park, with canyon walking and the famous glass bridge. Check the exact ticket and activity bundle.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Baofeng Lake

A lake excursion near Wulingyuan with boat-based sightseeing. An option for a gentler half-day, subject to local operations and weather.

Find on map

ZHANGJIAJIE

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Sanxiaguo

A shared hotpot-style local dish whose meat and offal combination varies. Ask what is included before ordering.

WHAT TO EAT

Smoked pork

Preserved pork commonly cooked with vegetables. Rich and salty, so pair a small plate with rice and greens.

WHAT TO EAT

Sour vegetables

Pickled vegetables appear in many local dishes. Request chilli separately where possible rather than assuming sour means mild.

YOUR BASE

Wulingyuan entrance area

Practical for repeat forest-park days and early starts. Confirm the exact entrance your accommodation serves.

YOUR BASE

Zhangjiajie city centre

Better for Tianmen Mountain and urban transport connections; it adds a road transfer to forest-park visits.

ZHANGJIAJIE

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Zhangjiajie West railway station and Hehua airport are not at the forest-park gate. Arrange the final transfer to your chosen base.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Inside the park, walking connects with managed buses and other transport. Cableways and lifts save ascent but do not remove all steps.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Tianmen Mountain and the Grand Canyon have separate entry systems. Do not treat them as add-ons inside the Wulingyuan park ticket.

TIME WELL SPENT

A mountain-focused stay

Use two days for complementary forest-park sectors, keeping one lower valley walk in the mix. Choose the daily order after seeing the forecast.

TIME WELL SPENT

A separate mountain day

Move or transfer to the city for Tianmen Mountain. Add the Grand Canyon only with another full day, not between departure connections.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Huangshan

Anhui / East

Granite peaks above, white-walled villages below.

Huangshan can mean the city, the mountain or the wider region of Huizhou villages. These are different bases. Decide whether your priority is summit scenery or village architecture, then build transport around that choice; a mountain hotel is a logistical decision as much as a scenic one.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO April-May · September-November

Photo: Chi King | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

HUANGSHAN

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Xidi

Huangshan / Anhui

Photo: EditQ | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING

Yellow Mountain

Plan the mountain route around your fitness and the day's weather.

Find on map

02 / DEDICATED OUTING

Hongcun

Stay long enough to see the village beyond its busiest midday hours.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Tunxi Old Street

Use the old town for an easy arrival evening and regional food.

Find on map

HUANGSHAN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / DEDICATED OUTING
Xidi

A full-day village excursion when paired carefully with nearby stops. Stone lanes and ancestral buildings offer a different atmosphere from the mountain.

Find on map

05 / DEDICATED OUTING
Chengkan

An old Huizhou village with lanes, waterways and traditional buildings. Allow time to explore on foot rather than stopping only for a photograph.

Find on map

06 / DEDICATED OUTING
Tangmo

A village excursion for waterside architecture and a slower walk. Check the transfer distance from your chosen base before adding another village.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING
Huizhou Ancient City

Historic streets and monuments in Shexian. An alternative to the mountain for travellers interested in architecture and regional history.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Xin'an River waterfront

An easy walk in the Tunxi area. Useful on an arrival evening when you do not have time for a mountain transfer.

Find on map

HUANGSHAN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Fermented mandarin fish

A strongly aromatic regional speciality, cooked before serving. Try it as a shared dish if your group enjoys bold flavours.

WHAT TO EAT

Hairy tofu

Fermented tofu with a distinctive surface, usually cooked at the stall or restaurant. Ask how it will be prepared.

WHAT TO EAT

Huangshan sesame pastries

Small baked pastries, often with savoury fillings. Handy for a travel day; check whether the filling contains pork.

YOUR BASE

Tunxi

Useful for arrival, old streets and regional transport. It is not at the mountain gate.

YOUR BASE

Tangkou / mountain hotels

Tangkou serves the southern mountain approach. A summit stay can reduce backtracking but involves carrying essentials up the mountain.

HUANGSHAN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Huangshan North station and Tunxi airport serve the wider region. Confirm whether your onward transfer ends in Tunxi, Tangkou or a village.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

The mountain uses managed transfers, cableways and walking paths. Expect stairs even when taking a cableway; choose a route suited to the group.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Group village visits geographically. Do not add Hongcun or Xidi after a demanding summit walk unless you have deliberately allowed another night.

TIME WELL SPENT

Mountains first

Transfer to the mountain base, then give the mountain a full day or an overnight stay. Keep the route flexible for visibility and closures.

TIME WELL SPENT

Village extension

Spend a separate day in Hongcun or Xidi and return to Tunxi for the old street. Avoid changing hotels every night if travelling with heavy luggage.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Dali

Yunnan / Southwest

Lake light, mountain air, and Bai architecture.

Dali combines a compact old town with a very large lake and mountain backdrop. The most satisfying visit chooses a few villages and short lakeside sections instead of attempting a hurried circuit. Bai architecture, food and craft traditions deserve as much time as the scenery.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · September-November

Photo: Yumeto | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

DALI

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Three Pagodas

Dali / Yunnan

Photo: Yumeto | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Dali Old Town

Explore smaller streets beyond the main shopping lanes.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Erhai

Choose a lakeside section for walking or cycling rather than rushing the whole shoreline.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Xizhou

Look for Bai courtyard architecture and explore the surrounding village landscape.

Find on map

DALI / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Three Pagodas

A landmark complex north of the old town. Give the extensive grounds time rather than treating it only as a roadside photograph.

Find on map

05 / DEDICATED OUTING

Cangshan

A mountain outing with cableways and walking routes. Choose your route for weather and fitness; high areas can feel much colder than town.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Zhoucheng

A village known for Bai tie-dye traditions. Look for a workshop explaining the process and clarify charges before joining an activity.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Shuanglang

A lakeside settlement on Erhai's eastern side with cafes and viewpoints. Plan the return transfer instead of assuming it is close to Dali Old Town.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Weishan

A full-day trip south of Dali for historic streets and local food. Best treated as its own excursion, not a stop on a lake circuit.

Find on map

DALI

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Rushan

A local dairy snack served in different ways, including grilled or fried. Check toppings if you prefer savoury to sweet.

WHAT TO EAT

Ersi noodles

Rice-based strands served in soup or stir-fried. A useful breakfast or quick lunch with locally varying toppings.

WHAT TO EAT

Bai-style fish casserole

A shared fish dish with vegetables and other ingredients. Confirm the recipe and price before ordering.

YOUR BASE

Dali Old Town

Convenient for meals and onward excursions; choose side streets if you want quieter nights.

YOUR BASE

Erhai villages

Good for a slow lakeside stay, but attractions across the lake require transfers and evening dining can be limited.

DALI

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Dali railway station is in the modern Xiaguan area, away from the old town. The airport also requires a separate transfer to your accommodation.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Explore the old town on foot and choose short lake-path walks or rides. Check where bikes are permitted rather than assuming a full lakeside circuit is straightforward.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Cangshan, eastern Erhai and Weishan are different outings. Shaxi is better considered as an onward stop or overnight excursion.

TIME WELL SPENT

Old town and lake

Spend one day in the old town and Three Pagodas area, then another around Xizhou and a nearby lakeside section.

TIME WELL SPENT

With a third day

Choose a suitable Cangshan route or Weishan's streets and food. Leave enough time to reach the railway station in Xiaguan.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Lijiang

Yunnan / Southwest

Naxi courtyards and mountains on the horizon.

Lijiang works best when you distinguish the busy old-town core from quieter villages and mountain excursions. Canal lanes can be atmospheric early in the day, while Baisha and the foothills offer a different pace. Keep a flexible mountain day rather than scheduling every hour.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · September-November

Photo: Pavel pindler | CC BY 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

LIJIANG

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Black Dragon Pool

Lijiang / Yunnan

Photo: Chris from Canada | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Lijiang Old Town

Explore early for quieter stone lanes and canal-side courtyards.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Baisha

Spend a slower afternoon learning about Naxi heritage and local workshops.

Find on map

03 / DEDICATED OUTING

Jade Dragon Snow Mountain

Make this a separate excursion and consider altitude and weather before booking.

Find on map

LIJIANG / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Black Dragon Pool

A landscaped park with mountain views when skies are clear. Pair it with a gentle old-town day rather than relying on a guaranteed reflection photograph.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shuhe Ancient Town

A second historic settlement with lanes, streams and shops. Spend time beyond the busiest commercial streets.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Mu's Residence

Courtyards associated with Lijiang's former ruling family. A useful introduction to local history within the old-town area.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yuhu Village

A stone-built village near the mountain foothills. Arrange return transport and respect working homes while walking through the lanes.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Tiger Leaping Gorge

A separate full-day excursion for viewpoints, or a longer stay for trekking. The viewing area and multi-day high trail are very different trips.

Find on map

LIJIANG

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Naxi baba

A local flatbread with sweet or savoury versions. Ask which filling is being served before buying.

WHAT TO EAT

Chickpea jelly

A cool or cooked chickpea-starch dish with seasoning. Chilli and other toppings vary from shop to shop.

WHAT TO EAT

Preserved pork-rib hotpot

A shared pot featuring cured ribs and vegetables. A substantial evening meal, with a naturally salty broth.

YOUR BASE

Dayan Old Town edge

Atmosphere with easier luggage access than the deepest lanes. Check noise from nearby bars.

YOUR BASE

Shuhe / Baisha

A quieter base for village time, with extra transfers for the city and station.

LIJIANG

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Lijiang railway station and Sanyi airport are outside the old-town lanes. Confirm the nearest vehicle drop-off point to your hotel.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Walk within each historic settlement, then use vehicles between them. Stone paving and steps make wheeled luggage awkward.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Jade Dragon Snow Mountain and Tiger Leaping Gorge need separate days. Confirm route difficulty and current access before committing to a mountain excursion.

TIME WELL SPENT

Town and villages

Start with Dayan and Black Dragon Pool. Spend another day in Baisha or Shuhe with time for a meal and local crafts.

TIME WELL SPENT

Mountain extension

Reserve a separate weather-dependent day for the snow mountain. Add the gorge only with enough time for the return journey or an overnight stay.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Kunming

Yunnan / Southwest

A gentle beginning to Yunnan.

Kunming is worth a pause between Yunnan destinations. Lake walks, temples, markets and a strong provincial museum offer an introduction to the region without constant hotel changes. The Stone Forest lies outside the city, so keep it separate from a day of urban exploring.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · October-November

Photo: xiquinhosilva | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

KUNMING

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Yuantong Temple

Kunming / Yunnan

Photo: Gisling | CC BY 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Green Lake

Start with a relaxed lake walk and nearby cafés.

Find on map

02 / DEDICATED OUTING

Stone Forest

Set aside a separate day for the karst landscape outside the city.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yunnan Provincial Museum

Use the collections to put the province's varied histories into context.

Find on map

KUNMING / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yuantong Temple

An active Buddhist temple near central Kunming. Combine it with Green Lake for a calm walking day.

Find on map

05 / DEDICATED OUTING

Western Hills

A hill-and-temple excursion overlooking Dianchi. Allow time for transport, stairs and weather-dependent views.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Dianchi lakeshore

A broad lake setting for a gentle walk. Choose a specific shore or park entrance rather than navigating simply to the lake.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Dounan Flower Market

A working flower-trading area with a different rhythm from a museum. Check visiting arrangements and give traders space.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Golden Temple

A historic temple complex in wooded grounds northeast of the centre. A separate half-day outing if you enjoy architecture and parks.

Find on map

KUNMING

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Crossing-the-bridge noodles

Rice noodles served with broth and separate ingredients. Follow the restaurant's instructions for adding and cooking the ingredients.

WHAT TO EAT

Small-pot rice noodles

A comforting single-bowl meal with local toppings. Check the broth and meat content if you have dietary needs.

WHAT TO EAT

Flower cakes

Pastries often filled with rose petals. Buy a small fresh batch and check storage instructions before taking them onward.

YOUR BASE

Green Lake / city centre

Good for walking, food and a first short stay. A nearby metro stop makes onward travel easier.

YOUR BASE

Kunming South station area

Useful for an early train, but distant from many central sights; choose it for logistics rather than atmosphere.

KUNMING

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Changshui airport, Kunming station and Kunming South are separate hubs. Check the departure station before choosing an overnight stop.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

The metro helps with longer urban journeys. Group Green Lake and Yuantong together, and give southern museum or lake visits their own time.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

The Stone Forest requires an onward transfer beyond the city. Jiuxiang is another excursion, not an effortless add-on after a full sightseeing day.

TIME WELL SPENT

A city pause

Combine Green Lake and Yuantong, with a noodle lunch. On another day choose the provincial museum or the Western Hills and lake area.

TIME WELL SPENT

A landscape day

Give the Stone Forest its own day and keep the return evening easy before onward travel to Dali or Lijiang.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Guiyang

Guizhou / Southwest

Mountain flavours and an easy gateway to Guizhou.

Guiyang is a useful introduction to Guizhou, with riverside landmarks, forested hills and a food culture built around sour and spicy flavours. The province is much larger than its capital: waterfalls and village stays need their own travel days rather than being presented as city attractions.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO April-June · September-October

Photo: Harry Alverson | CC BY-SA 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

GUIYANG

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Qingyan Ancient Town

Guiyang / Guizhou

Photo: Harry Alverson | CC BY-SA 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING

Qingyan Ancient Town

Spend half a day exploring stone lanes and historic architecture.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Qianling Park

Walk the wooded paths and keep food secured around wildlife.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Jiaxiu Pavilion

Visit the riverside landmark, then explore central Guiyang's food streets.

Find on map

GUIYANG / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Guizhou Provincial Museum

A starting point for the province's history and cultural traditions. Pair it with nearby northern-city plans, not a rushed transfer to Qingyan.

Find on map

05 / DEDICATED OUTING

Tianhetan

A scenic excursion southwest of the centre with water and cave landscapes. Allow a half-day or longer and check the available routes.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Huaxi Park

A riverside park in the southern district. A gentler outdoor visit that can fit a day based around Huaxi.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Wenchang Pavilion

A historic city landmark suited to a shorter central walk. Combine it with nearby streets rather than travelling across town only for this stop.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Huangguoshu Waterfall

A separate full-day trip or overnight excursion near Anshun. Transfers and scenic-area walking make it unsuitable as a quick Guiyang city stop.

Find on map

GUIYANG

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Sour-soup fish

A shared fish dish with a sour broth associated with Guizhou's wider food traditions. Confirm fish size and price first.

WHAT TO EAT

Siwawa

Small wrappers filled with vegetable strips and dipping sauce. Ask about the sauce if avoiding meat or seafood ingredients.

WHAT TO EAT

Changwang noodles

A strongly flavoured noodle dish commonly containing intestines and blood curd. Check the toppings before ordering.

YOUR BASE

Jiaxiu / central Nanming

Useful for evening walks and local food. Choose a metro connection for longer journeys.

YOUR BASE

Guanshanhu / Guiyang North

Newer hotels and convenient rail logistics, with more travel to the historic central areas.

GUIYANG

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Longdongbao airport and Guiyang North or East railway stations serve different journeys. Confirm the final city transfer before booking a tight connection.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use the metro between districts and walking within each area. Hills and larger roads can make a short map distance less convenient than expected.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Qingyan lies to the south; Huangguoshu and distant village destinations require separate planning. Do not treat all of Guizhou as a day-trip radius.

TIME WELL SPENT

Two city days

Pair Qianling Park with central food streets and an evening near Jiaxiu. Give Qingyan a separate outing, optionally with a nearby Huaxi stop.

TIME WELL SPENT

Extend into Guizhou

Choose Huangguoshu or an overnight village journey as the next leg. Keep time in the schedule for regional transfers.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Xiamen

Fujian / South

Sea breezes, island lanes, and Fujian flavours.

Xiamen lends itself to days shaped by the coast: a temple, a small district of shops and cafes, then a waterfront walk. Gulangyu is a separate island visit with ferry logistics. The Fujian tulou are much farther inland and deserve their own excursion.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · October-November

Photo: - - | CC BY 2.5

Original photograph & licensing

XIAMEN

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING
Gulangyu

Reserve the appropriate visitor ferry and leave time for walking the island.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Shapowei

Explore the harbour-side neighbourhood and small creative spaces.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
South Putuo Temple

Visit the temple respectfully and combine it with nearby city walks.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Hulishan Fortress

A coastal fort with historic artillery. Pair it with a nearby seafront walk instead of another cross-island journey.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Huandao Road coast

Choose a manageable section of shoreline for walking or cycling. The whole coastal road is much longer than a casual stroll.

Find on map

XIAMEN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Zhongshan Road

Covered shopping streets and snack stops near the old centre. Explore side streets and compare prices before buying food gifts.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Jimei School Village

Architecture and waterfront spaces on the mainland side of Xiamen. Give the cross-water journey and walking time a half-day.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Fujian tulou

A full-day trip or overnight excursion to inland earthen-building clusters. Choose one cluster and a realistic transfer plan; they are not in Xiamen city.

Find on map

XIAMEN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Shacha noodles

Noodles in a rich sauce-based broth with selectable toppings. Peanut and seafood ingredients may be present.

WHAT TO EAT

Oyster omelette

Small oysters cooked with egg and starch. Best ordered freshly cooked and shared alongside other dishes.

WHAT TO EAT

Peanut soup

A sweet peanut dessert, often eaten warm. A gentle finish to a snack walk around the older shopping streets.

YOUR BASE

Zhongshan Road / old centre

Good for food and waterfront walks; confirm the departure terminal for any Gulangyu ferry.

YOUR BASE

Huandao Road coast

Quieter seaside stays with more space, but extra journeys for city restaurants and rail connections.

XIAMEN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Xiamen and Xiamen North railway stations are different: North is on the mainland. Check the airport and terminal named on your actual flight booking.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Metro and buses connect districts; walk within coastal neighbourhoods. Gulangyu ferry terminal and passenger arrangements need checking before setting out.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Tulou clusters require substantial road travel. Do not combine them with Gulangyu on a single day.

TIME WELL SPENT

Coast and island

Give Gulangyu a full, unhurried day. Use another for South Putuo, Shapowei and a selected coastal walk.

TIME WELL SPENT

An extra day

Choose Jimei for architecture or a separately arranged tulou excursion. Leave a buffer before an onward flight.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Guangzhou

Guangdong / South

Come hungry. Stay for the neighbourhoods.

Guangzhou is a food city with layers of river trade, clan architecture and modern development. Plan meals as part of the route: morning tea can be the main event. The western old-city districts and the eastern skyline work best on different days.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO October-December · March-April

Photo: Shujianyang | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

GUANGZHOU

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Canton Tower

Guangzhou / Guangdong

Photo: Tim Wu | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Chen Clan Ancestral Hall

Look closely at the woodwork, ceramics and carved decoration.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shamian

Take a slow walk through the island's historic streets.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Liwan

Explore Xiguan lanes and make time for a proper Cantonese breakfast.

Find on map

GUANGZHOU / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Canton Tower

A modern riverfront landmark with optional elevated views. A clear evening is more useful than squeezing it into a cloudy afternoon.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yuexiu Park

A large urban park with historic landmarks and shaded paths. Choose a short loop if travelling in hot weather.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Museum of the Nanyue King

Archaeological collections that explain an older chapter of the city. Confirm the museum branch associated with the exhibits you want.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Sacred Heart Cathedral

A distinctive stone cathedral in the older city. Respect worship times and any visitor restrictions.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Baiyun Mountain

A hill-and-park outing north of the centre. Allow a half-day or longer and select a route that suits the group's walking ability.

Find on map

GUANGZHOU

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Dim sum

Small steamed and baked dishes served with tea. Order gradually so the table does not fill with more food than you need.

WHAT TO EAT

Wonton noodles

Fine noodles and filled dumplings in broth, often with pork and shrimp. A practical light meal between walks.

WHAT TO EAT

Cantonese roast meats

Roast goose, duck and char siu are common options. A rice plate lets a solo traveller try a small portion.

YOUR BASE

Liwan / old western centre

Good for traditional food and historic streets. Check hotel condition and walking distance to the metro.

YOUR BASE

Tianhe / Zhujiang New Town

Modern hotels and transport links, with more commuting to the older neighbourhoods.

GUANGZHOU

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Baiyun airport and Guangzhou South railway station sit outside the old centre. Check the exact station: Guangzhou, East and South are not interchangeable.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Metro travel is useful between the old centre and newer eastern districts. Walk shorter shaded sections in warm weather.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Foshan is a separate city visit even when rail links make it accessible. Allow time at both ends of any intercity journey.

TIME WELL SPENT

Old and new

Combine Chen Clan Ancestral Hall, Liwan and Shamian on an old-city day. Explore the modern riverfront on a separate afternoon and evening.

TIME WELL SPENT

Slow the pace

Reserve a morning for tea, then choose a museum or Baiyun Mountain rather than adding multiple distant sights.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Shenzhen

Guangdong / South

Design, urban parks, and a city still becoming.

Shenzhen is most interesting as a lived-in modern city: design districts, parks, neighbourhood food and a long coastline. Attractions are widely spread. Decide whether your stay is urban or beach-focused before choosing a hotel, as the eastern coast is a different journey.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO October-December · March-April

Photo: Charlie fong | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

SHENZHEN

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Lianhuashan Park

Shenzhen / Guangdong

Photo: jo.sau from London/Vilnius, UK/Lithuania | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

OCT Loft

Explore galleries, design shops and cafés at your own pace.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shenzhen Bay Park

Choose a section of the waterfront for an evening walk.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Dafen

Visit painting workshops and ask before photographing artists at work.

Find on map

SHENZHEN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Lianhuashan Park

A central park with a hilltop view over the civic district. Visit in cooler hours and expect a climb to the viewpoint.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shenzhen Museum

City and regional history in museum settings. Check the branch and exhibition location before travelling.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Window of the World

A theme park of architectural replicas and entertainment. A deliberate family choice, not a substitute for the city's own neighbourhoods.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Dameisha

A beach excursion east of the centre. Allow for traffic, weather and beach-management rules.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Dapeng Fortress

A full-day trip to historic lanes in the eastern peninsula area. Pair only with nearby coastal stops, not central-city sightseeing.

Find on map

SHENZHEN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Cantonese dim sum

An easy introduction to southern Chinese dining. Share several small dishes and tea instead of ordering a large fixed meal.

WHAT TO EAT

Hakka-style dishes

Look for stuffed tofu and other Hakka dishes reflecting the region's older communities. Fillings often include meat.

WHAT TO EAT

Seafood

Coastal restaurants offer fish and shellfish prepared in several styles. Confirm weight, cooking charge and total price before ordering.

YOUR BASE

Futian

A practical base for central parks, museums and transport; choose your station carefully in this large district.

YOUR BASE

Nanshan / Shekou

Good for western waterfront and dining, but farther from eastern beaches and some rail departures.

SHENZHEN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Bao'an airport, Shenzhen North, Futian and Shenzhen railway stations serve different routes. Cross-border journeys require their own document and timing checks.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use the metro for urban trips and group sights by district. Long east-west journeys can consume much of an afternoon.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Dameisha and Dapeng need dedicated coastal time. Avoid an eastern beach trip immediately before a tightly scheduled train or flight.

TIME WELL SPENT

Urban introduction

Pair central parks and a museum on one day. Use another for OCT Loft and a Shenzhen Bay walk.

TIME WELL SPENT

Coastal extension

Add Dapeng or Dameisha as a separate outing. Choose according to whether history or beach time matters more to your group.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Hong Kong

Hong Kong SAR / South

Harbour crossings and hills behind the skyline.

Hong Kong combines compact urban walks with surprisingly spacious coast and country parks. A harbour crossing is part of the experience, but hills and islands deserve their own time. Treat it as a separate travel jurisdiction when planning documents, payment and onward connections.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO October-December · March-April

Photo: Base64, retouched by CarolSpears | CC BY-SA 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

HONG KONG

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Nan Lian Garden and Chi Lin Nunnery

Hong Kong / Hong Kong SAR

Photo: Wpcpey | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Star Ferry

Cross Victoria Harbour and explore both waterfronts.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Victoria Peak

Choose a clear day and leave time for the walking paths.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Sheung Wan

Walk the older streets, small shops and neighbourhood cafés.

Find on map

HONG KONG / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Tsim Sha Tsui waterfront

An accessible introduction to the harbour skyline. Combine it with nearby museums or a ferry crossing rather than a long checklist.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hong Kong Museum of History

Historical context for the city. Check the current exhibitions before choosing how much time to spend.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Nan Lian Garden and Chi Lin Nunnery

A landscaped garden and Buddhist complex in Kowloon. Keep the visit quiet and follow photography guidance.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Lantau and Ngong Ping

A full-day trip for mountain scenery and the Tian Tan Buddha area. Transport choice and weather affect the experience.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Dragon's Back

A separate hiking outing with coastal views. Check weather, route conditions and your group's ability before leaving urban transport behind.

Find on map

HONG KONG

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Dim sum and tea

Choose a few steamed, fried and baked dishes to share. Some restaurants use timed sessions or different ordering systems.

WHAT TO EAT

Wonton noodles

A compact meal of noodles and dumplings, commonly containing shrimp and pork. Useful between neighbourhood walks.

WHAT TO EAT

Cha chaan teng breakfast

Local cafes serve combinations such as eggs, toast, noodles and milk tea. Menus and ordering conventions vary.

YOUR BASE

Tsim Sha Tsui / Jordan

Convenient for Kowloon dining and harbour access; room sizes can be compact.

YOUR BASE

Sheung Wan / Central

Good for island neighbourhood walks and ferries, with slopes and steps to consider when choosing a hotel.

HONG KONG

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

The airport, West Kowloon rail terminal and land crossings have distinct onward journeys. Check entry requirements separately from mainland China.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

MTR, buses, trams and ferries suit different journeys. Walking routes on Hong Kong Island may involve steep slopes and stairs.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Lantau, outlying islands and hiking routes each need time for return transport. Avoid planning the last service as your only way back.

TIME WELL SPENT

Harbour and neighbourhoods

Pair Kowloon waterfront time with a Star Ferry crossing. Explore Sheung Wan and Central on another day, adding the Peak in suitable weather.

TIME WELL SPENT

A greener day

Choose Lantau, an island or a manageable hike. Keep a city alternative if weather makes the outdoor plan unattractive.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Macao

Macao SAR / South

A small city with many layers of history.

Macao rewards looking beyond the resort complexes. Its compact historic streets, Chinese temples and Portuguese-influenced buildings tell a layered story, while Taipa and Coloane offer different rhythms. Separate travel-document and payment arrangements from any mainland portion of your trip.

SUGGESTED STAY 1-2 days

WHEN TO GO October-December · March-April

Photo: GG001213 | CC0

Original photograph & licensing

MACAO

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

A-Ma Temple

Macao / Macao SAR

Photo: WiNG | CC BY 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Historic Centre

Walk between Senado Square and the Ruins of St Paul's.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Taipa Village

Explore narrow streets and stop for local food.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Coloane

Leave time for the village waterfront and a quieter afternoon.

Find on map

MACAO / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

A-Ma Temple

An active temple complex on the peninsula with courtyards and steps. Respect worshippers and explore the surrounding streets slowly.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Mandarin's House

A traditional residential complex offering a more intimate architectural visit than the major public squares.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Guia Fortress

A hilltop historic site with city views. Allow for the ascent and check which interiors are accessible.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Macao Museum

Historical context beside the Monte Fort area. A useful companion to an old-centre walk rather than a separate cross-city trip.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hac Sa Beach

A quieter coastal outing on Coloane. Choose it for a walk and change of atmosphere; check local conditions before entering the water.

Find on map

MACAO

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Portuguese-style egg tarts

Small custard pastries with browned tops. Buy a few fresh rather than carrying a large box through a hot day.

WHAT TO EAT

Minchi

A home-style minced-meat dish often served with potatoes, rice and an egg. Recipes vary between restaurants.

WHAT TO EAT

Almond cookies

A crumbly local souvenir snack. Compare ingredients, freshness and packaging if taking a box home.

YOUR BASE

Historic peninsula

Best for walking between old-centre sights and small restaurants; some streets are steep or narrow.

YOUR BASE

Taipa / Cotai

More resort-style accommodation and larger complexes, with transport needed for peninsula sightseeing.

MACAO

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Check whether you arrive by airport, ferry or land crossing. Terminal choice changes the local transfer, and entry rules differ from mainland China.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Walk compact historic areas and use buses or taxis between the peninsula, Taipa and Coloane. Large resort interiors can add substantial walking.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

An onward Hong Kong or Zhuhai journey requires a separate transport and border plan. Leave time beyond the scheduled ride itself.

TIME WELL SPENT

Historic day

Link the central squares and lanes with the museum or Mandarin's House. Keep a separate block for A-Ma Temple and its surroundings.

TIME WELL SPENT

Island day

Explore Taipa Village, then move to Coloane for a slower afternoon and a meal. Avoid rushing back across districts for every snack.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Nanjing

Jiangsu / East

Old capital, leafy avenues, living history.

Nanjing has the scale of a former capital: walls, lakes, museums and wooded hills spread across the city. Choose a historical theme for each day rather than trying to connect all the monuments. Some sites invite reflection, so leave space between them and more recreational stops.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · October-November

Photo: xiquinhosilva | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

NANJING

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Ming Xiaoling Mausoleum

Nanjing / Jiangsu

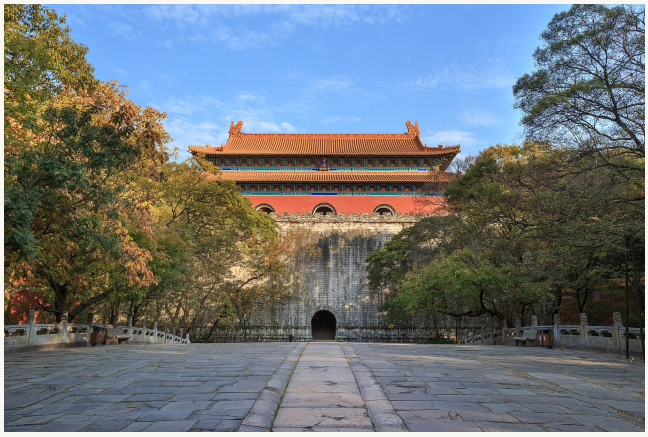

Photo: Zhangzhugang | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Nanjing City Wall

Choose a section to walk rather than attempting its full extent.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Nanjing Museum

Allow a substantial half-day for the collections.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Purple Mountain

Pick one or two sites in this large scenic area and plan transport between them.

Find on map

NANJING / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Confucius Temple and Qinhuai River

A busy riverside district of lanes, food and evening lights. Explore side streets as well as the main visitor route.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Xuanwu Lake

A broad lakeside park beside the city wall. Choose one shore or island loop for a relaxed outdoor break.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Presidential Palace

Historic government buildings and gardens in the centre. Allow time for the exhibitions rather than only photographing the entrance.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Sun Yat-sen Mausoleum

A major monument on Purple Mountain with a substantial stair approach. Check reservation and access arrangements before travelling.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Ming Xiaoling Mausoleum

A wooded historic complex on Purple Mountain. Give the paths and monuments enough walking time; it is not beside every other mountain attraction.

Find on map

NANJING

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT
Salted duck

A signature cold duck dish with a savoury, restrained seasoning. Order a small portion with other dishes.

WHAT TO EAT
Duck-blood vermicelli soup

A local soup commonly containing duck blood curd and offal. Check ingredients before ordering.

WHAT TO EAT
Tangbao

Soup-filled buns served hot. Let them cool and eat carefully to avoid spilling the broth.

YOUR BASE
Xinjiekou

Central transport and plentiful dining, useful for a first visit across several districts.

YOUR BASE
Qinhuai / Confucius Temple area

Good evening atmosphere, but check noise and vehicle access on pedestrian streets.

NANJING

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Nanjing South and Nanjing railway stations sit in different parts of the city. Lukou airport requires a separate transfer.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use metro journeys between districts and walking inside large historic sites. Purple Mountain still involves local transfers and substantial walking.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Allow a dedicated day for selected Purple Mountain sites. Do not underestimate the distance between individual entrances.

TIME WELL SPENT

City history

Combine a central museum or palace visit with a selected city-wall section. Use another afternoon for Qinhuai streets and dinner.

TIME WELL SPENT

Wooded monuments

Choose two compatible Purple Mountain sites for an extra day. Adjust the plan if stairs or hot weather would make it demanding.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Luoyang

Henan / Central

Stone-carved stories along the Yi River.

Luoyang places ancient capitals and Buddhist art alongside a modern city. Longmen is the anchor for many first visits, but museums and old-city food add context. Peony season changes the atmosphere considerably; outside it, the historical sights remain the main reason to stay.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO April-May · September-October

Photo: xiquinhosilva | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

LUOYANG

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING
Longmen Grottoes

Give the riverside Buddhist carvings several unhurried hours.

Find on map

02 / DEDICATED OUTING
White Horse Temple

Explore the temple grounds and learn about its place in Buddhist history.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Luoyang Museum

Use the collections to understand the city's long role as a capital.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Lijing Gate and old streets

An old-city gateway and surrounding lanes suited to an evening food walk. Expect a lively commercial area rather than an untouched town.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Sui-Tang Luoyang City National Heritage Park

Reconstructed monuments and archaeological interpretation. Distinguish modern reconstructions from surviving historic remains while exploring.

Find on map

LUOYANG / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Guanlin Temple

A temple complex associated with Guan Yu, south of the centre. Can fit a southern-city day if travel time allows.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

National Peony Garden

A seasonal flower destination. Choose it for the actual flowering period rather than expecting peonies throughout the year.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Luoyang Ancient Tombs Museum

A specialised museum for burial history and mural traditions. Check current access and allow a separate transfer from central sights.

Find on map

LUOYANG

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Luoyang water banquet

A succession of soup-based and sauced dishes, traditionally shared. A smaller selection may suit a couple better than a full banquet.

WHAT TO EAT

Beef or mutton soup

A local breakfast tradition, often served with bread. Ask about portions and seasoning before adding chilli.

WHAT TO EAT

Jiangmian

Noodles in a fermented, tangy broth. Try a small bowl if you are unfamiliar with the flavour.

YOUR BASE

Old city / Lijing Gate

Useful for evening food and historic streets, with travel needed for Longmen.

YOUR BASE

Luoyang Longmen station area

Convenient for fast trains and southern sights; less suited to spontaneous old-city evening walks.

LUOYANG

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Luoyang Longmen is the main high-speed station for many visitors; central Luoyang station is separate. Check the station name on every ticket.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use the metro where it suits your route and vehicles for outlying sites. Longmen involves outdoor walking after arrival.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Shaolin and Mount Song are separate excursions toward Dengfeng. They should not be squeezed into a full Longmen day.

TIME WELL SPENT

Art and context

Give Longmen a generous visit, then keep the evening light. Use another day for Luoyang Museum and the old streets.

TIME WELL SPENT

A seasonal addition

Choose a peony garden in bloom or a specialist heritage site. Reserve a separate day if continuing toward Shaolin.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Datong

Shanxi / North

Buddhist masterpieces and the open skies of Shanxi.

Datong is an excellent base for Buddhist art and northern architecture. The restored old centre is easy to understand on foot, while the cave temples and suspended monastery lie outside it. A successful visit separates these excursions instead of turning every day into a long road circuit.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO May-June · September-October

Photo: xiquinhosilva | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

DATONG

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING

Yungang Grottoes

Allow time for the main caves and the sculptural details.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Huayan Temple

Explore the temple and the surrounding old-city streets.

Find on map

03 / DEDICATED OUTING

Hanging Temple

Arrange a separate outing and consider the narrow elevated walkways.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Nine Dragon Screen

A colourful glazed architectural screen in the old city. A compact stop that fits naturally into a central walking route.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shanhua Temple

Historic Buddhist halls and sculpture near the southern old city. A useful contrast with Huayan Temple.

Find on map

DATONG / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Datong City Wall

A restored wall circuit and viewpoints over the old centre. Choose a section rather than feeling obliged to walk the entire perimeter.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Datong Museum

Regional archaeology and historical context. Check the location and opening arrangements before adding it to an old-city day.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Hengshan

A separate mountain outing near Hunyuan. Combine only with nearby plans and allow for stairs, weather and return travel.

Find on map

DATONG

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Knife-cut noodles

Thick wheat noodles shaved into the pot and served with varied toppings. A satisfying, inexpensive main meal.

WHAT TO EAT

Yellow-rice cakes

Millet-based cakes, often fried. A rich local snack to share alongside a lighter dish.

WHAT TO EAT

Shaomai

Steamed dumplings with pleated tops and regional fillings. Confirm the filling rather than assuming a southern-style recipe.

YOUR BASE

Inside the old city

Convenient for temples and evening walks. Confirm the nearest vehicle access point if arriving with luggage.

YOUR BASE

Datong South area

Useful for an early train, but it adds travel to the old-city sights and restaurants.

DATONG

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Datong South railway station is outside the historic centre. Yungang airport also requires a city transfer.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Walk between central temples and use a vehicle for Yungang. Winter weather can make outdoor waits and long walks uncomfortable.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

The Hanging Temple and Hengshan are near Hunyuan, not beside Yungang. Treat the eastern and western excursions as separate days.

TIME WELL SPENT

City and caves

Use one day for Huayan, Shanhua and old-city lanes. Give Yungang another generous block with time for the return journey.

TIME WELL SPENT

Hunyuan extension

Add a separate Hanging Temple outing, with Hengshan only if your timing and walking ability allow.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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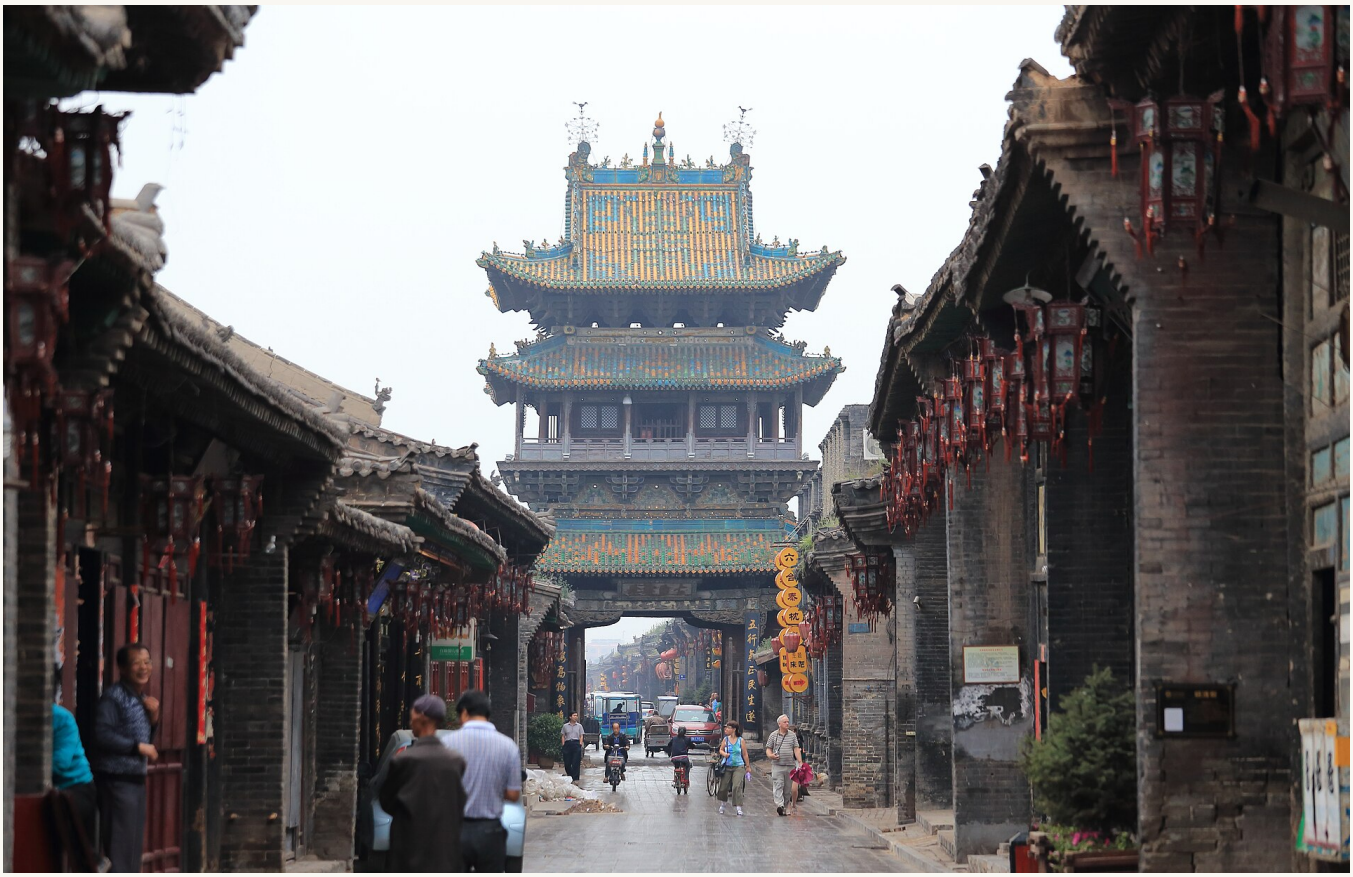
Pingyao

Shanxi / North



A walled town best experienced after the day trips leave.

Pingyao is most rewarding after the day-trip crowds thin out. Its lanes, courtyards and merchant history form a compact whole, while the painted sculpture in temples outside town adds another dimension. Stay long enough to see both the busy streets and quieter residential edges.

SUGGESTED STAY 2 days

WHEN TO GO April-June · September-October

Photo: Zhangzhugang | CC BY-SA 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

PINGYAO

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Zhenguo Temple

Pingyao / Shanxi

Photo: Zhangzhugang | CC BY-SA 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Ancient City

Walk the streets early and stay into the evening.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Rishengchang

Explore the history of banking and trade in Shanxi.

Find on map

03 / DEDICATED OUTING

Shuanglin Temple

Make time for the painted sculpture outside the walled town.

Find on map

PINGYAO / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Ancient City Wall

An elevated look over the town's roofscape. Choose an accessible section and allow for steps and exposed weather.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

County Government Office

Historic administrative courtyards that help explain how the town functioned. Take time for the sequence of spaces.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Confucian Temple

A quieter complex associated with education and ritual. A contrast to the commercial streets and banking museums.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

City God Temple

Traditional halls and decorative details within the old city. Follow local worship and photography guidance.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Zhenguo Temple

A separate excursion outside town for early timber architecture and sculpture. Arrange transport with a clear return plan.

Find on map

PINGYAO

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Pingyao beef

A prepared local beef speciality, often served sliced. Compare portions and packaging if buying it as a gift.

WHAT TO EAT

Wantuo

A local starch-based snack cut into pieces and seasoned. Recipes and hot or cold preparations vary.

WHAT TO EAT

Shanxi noodles

Try a noodle shape you have not eaten before, with vinegar on the side. Sauces commonly contain meat.

YOUR BASE

Old-city courtyard stay

Best for atmosphere and evening walks. Ask about heating, bathroom layout and luggage access.

YOUR BASE

Outside the walls

Often easier for vehicle access and modern rooms, but less immersive after dinner.

PINGYAO

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Pingyao Ancient City high-speed station is outside the old town; Pingyao station is different. Confirm the hotel's pickup or final walking directions.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Walking is the main way to explore the old centre. Comfortable shoes matter on uneven lanes and courtyard thresholds.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Shuanglin and Zhenguo temples require transfers outside the walls. Choose a realistic sequence rather than assuming they are neighbouring stops.

TIME WELL SPENT

A full old-city day

Mix one banking museum, an administrative or temple complex and a wall section. Leave time to wander after dinner.

TIME WELL SPENT

A second day

Choose Shuanglin or Zhenguo for sculpture and architecture, then return for a slower meal and any missed courtyards.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

TravelChinaGuide · Overview

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Tianjin

Tianjin / North

Riverfront architecture and an appetite for breakfast.

Tianjin is a rewarding short city break for river walks, varied architecture and northern snacks. The best route follows neighbourhoods rather than isolated landmarks. Its urban centre and Binhai district are far apart, so decide whether you want a central-city stay or a coastal extension.

SUGGESTED STAY 1-2 days

WHEN TO GO April-May · September-October

Photo: KangTyngrwey | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

TIANJIN

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Tianjin Eye

Tianjin / Tianjin

Photo: KangTyngrwey | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Five Great Avenues

Explore the historic residential streets on foot.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hai River

Walk the riverfront and cross a few bridges for changing city views.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Ancient Culture Street

Browse traditional crafts and compare before buying.

Find on map

TIANJIN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Italian Style Town

A compact district of historic buildings and dining streets. Visit as part of a river walk rather than expecting a large preserved town.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Tianjin Eye

A river-spanning observation wheel and recognisable landmark. The riverside view can be enjoyable without joining the ride.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Tianjin Museum

Regional history and art in the cultural-centre district. A useful indoor alternative to a long architectural walk.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Jingyuan Garden

A historic residence associated with Puyi. A focused visit for travellers interested in the city's modern history.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Porcelain House

A highly decorated building covered with ceramic elements. Choose it for its unusual appearance and check what the interior visit includes.

Find on map

TIANJIN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Jianbing guozi

A freshly made savoury breakfast crepe with crisp or fried filling. Ask for chilli according to your preference.

WHAT TO EAT

Goubuli-style steamed buns

A well-known local bun tradition. Compare menus and portions rather than choosing only by a famous sign.

WHAT TO EAT

Fried dough twists

Crunchy mahua pastries sold as snacks and gifts. Check freshness and ingredients before buying a large box.

YOUR BASE

Five Great Avenues area

Good for slower architectural walks and cafes, with quieter streets away from major roads.

YOUR BASE

Hai River / central station area

Convenient for arrivals and river walks; confirm which station your train uses.

TIANJIN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Tianjin station, Tianjin West and Tianjin South are distinct. Binhai airport and Binhai district add separate transfers.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Walk the central riverfront and use the metro between districts. A bicycle route may be pleasant only where traffic and road conditions suit you.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Binhai attractions are not central-city stops. Reserve a separate day if heading toward the coast.

TIME WELL SPENT

Two easy city days

Pair the river and Italian Style Town on arrival. Spend another day around the Five Great Avenues and a museum or historic residence.

TIME WELL SPENT

For a shorter visit

Choose architecture or the old commercial streets as your focus, with a relaxed local meal before your train.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Qingdao

Shandong / East

Red roofs, sea air, and long coastal walks.

Qingdao has several coastal personalities: the old hill streets, leafy villa districts and newer eastern waterfront. Choose a few connected sections rather than attempting the whole shoreline. Sea fog and wind can change the mood quickly, making museums and food useful alternatives.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO May-June · September-October

Photo: xiquinhosilva | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

QINGDAO

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

St. Michael's Cathedral

Qingdao / Shandong

Photo: Noraft | Public domain

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Badaguan

Walk the leafy streets and pause by the coast.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Zhanqiao

Explore the old seafront around the historic pier.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Qingdao Beer Museum

Learn about brewing history and arrange safe transport if tasting.

Find on map

QINGDAO / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

St. Michael's Cathedral

A landmark in the old city with a photogenic surrounding square. Respect worship and visitor rules inside.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Signal Hill Park

A compact hill park with views over tiled roofs and the sea. Expect steps and choose a clear day.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

May Fourth Square

A modern waterfront landmark in the eastern city. Pair it with nearby coastal paths rather than old-town sights on foot.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Olympic Sailing Centre

Marina views and open waterfront space near the modern centre. Good for a late-afternoon walk when conditions are pleasant.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Laoshan

A full-day mountain excursion outside the city. Choose one scenic sector and confirm transport and walking requirements.

Find on map

QINGDAO

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Seafood

Clams, fish and other seafood appear on many menus. Confirm whether pricing is per portion or by weight.

WHAT TO EAT

Qingdao beer

A local brewing tradition encountered in restaurants and the museum. Pair tastings with a meal and arrange transport accordingly.

WHAT TO EAT

Seafood dumplings

Dumplings may contain fish, shellfish, pork or mixed fillings. Ask for the exact filling if you have dietary needs.

YOUR BASE

Old town / Qingdao station

Best for historic streets and western waterfront walks, though some roads are steep.

YOUR BASE

May Fourth Square area

Modern hotels and transport connections, with a different atmosphere from the old city.

QINGDAO

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Jiaodong airport is well outside the centre. Qingdao and Qingdao North stations serve different journeys.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use metro links between the old and new centres, then walk short coastal sections. Hills make some inland shortcuts demanding.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Laoshan has multiple scenic areas. Choose one entrance and route rather than treating the mountain as a single quick stop.

TIME WELL SPENT

Old coast and new coast

Combine Zhanqiao, old streets and Signal Hill on one day. Use another for Badaguan and a selected eastern waterfront section.

TIME WELL SPENT

A mountain day

Add Laoshan only with a full day and suitable weather. Keep the beer museum as an urban alternative.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Jinan

Shandong / East

A city shaped by springs and everyday waterside life.

Jinan is a city to explore through water: springs, canals and lakes link its historic core. The small lanes reward walking slowly, while hills and museums offer contrast. Spring flow and weather vary, so enjoy the surrounding gardens as well as the water itself.

SUGGESTED STAY 2 days

WHEN TO GO April-May · September-October

Photo: Ermell | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

JINAN

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Thousand Buddha Mountain

Jinan / Shandong

Photo: Ermell | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Baotu Spring

Explore the spring-fed gardens and surrounding paths.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Daming Lake

Leave time for a leisurely lakeside walk.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Qushuiting Street

Look for small waterways and old neighbourhood details.

Find on map

JINAN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Black Tiger Spring

A spring and waterside walking area near the old centre. Combine it with adjacent canals instead of making a separate vehicle trip.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Five Dragon Pool

A central park of pools and greenery. A quieter counterpoint to busier landmark spring gardens.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Thousand Buddha Mountain

A hill excursion south of the centre with temples and city views. Allow time for the ascent and weather.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shandong Museum

Provincial history and art in the eastern city. Check exhibition and reservation arrangements before travelling.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Furong Street

A busy pedestrian food street near the historic core. Browse side lanes too and choose freshly prepared snacks.

Find on map

JINAN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Youxuan

A layered, coiled savoury pastry. Best tried fresh as part of breakfast or a snack stop.

WHAT TO EAT

Tianmo

A savoury millet-based soup despite the sweet-sounding name. Ingredients can include vegetables, peanuts and other additions.

WHAT TO EAT

Sweet-sour carp

A recognisable Shandong banquet dish, best shared. Ask about portion size before ordering alongside other plates.

YOUR BASE

Quancheng Square / old centre

Convenient for springs, lanes and dining, with many sights reachable on foot.

YOUR BASE

Eastern museum district

Useful for newer hotels and museum visits, but less convenient for repeated old-city walks.

JINAN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Jinan, Jinan West and Jinan East are separate railway stations. Yaoqiang airport adds a road or public-transport transfer.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Walk between the central spring areas, using buses, taxis or rail transit for longer journeys where the route fits.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Mount Tai is a separate destination requiring its own transport and mountain plan. Do not attach it casually to a full Jinan day.

TIME WELL SPENT

Follow the water

Pair Baotu Spring and Five Dragon Pool with the old lanes. Spend another block around Daming Lake and Qushuiting Street.

TIME WELL SPENT

A different day

Choose Thousand Buddha Mountain in suitable weather or Shandong Museum for an indoor history visit.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Harbin

Heilongjiang / Northeast

Winter spectacle and a distinctive northern cityscape.

Harbin changes dramatically with the seasons. Winter brings ice attractions and short, very cold days; warmer months favour river walks and architecture. Plan the ordinary city first, then add seasonal events only after checking their actual dates and operating conditions.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-4 days

WHEN TO GO January-February · June-August

Photo: N509FZ | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

HARBIN

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Central Street

Walk the pedestrian street and look up at its architecture.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Saint Sophia Cathedral

Explore the landmark's square and check interior opening arrangements.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Songhua River

Enjoy the waterfront; seasonal ice activities require official operating confirmation.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Sun Island

A large park area across the river, with different summer and winter experiences. Confirm which section or event you intend to visit.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Ice and Snow World

A seasonal winter attraction requiring a dedicated outing. Opening dates and conditions vary; do not assume it exists year-round.

Find on map

HARBIN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Lao Daowai

Older commercial streets and Chinese-Baroque-style architecture. Explore thoughtfully, distinguishing restored visitor areas from working neighbourhoods.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Heilongjiang Provincial Museum

Regional collections that add context to an architectural city visit. Check current exhibitions and access.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Stalin Park

A riverside promenade near Central Street. A good short walk, adjusted for wind, temperature and river conditions.

Find on map

HARBIN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Guobaorou

Crisp pork pieces with a sweet-sour coating. A classic shared plate in northeastern restaurants.

WHAT TO EAT

Harbin red sausage

A local smoked-sausage tradition. Check ingredients, storage and customs restrictions before considering it as a take-home gift.

WHAT TO EAT

Northeastern dumplings

Generous boiled dumplings with meat or vegetable fillings. Order gradually: portions can be substantial.

YOUR BASE

Central Street / Daoli

Convenient for architecture, food and river walks. Check heating and room comfort for winter visits.

YOUR BASE

Harbin West station area

Practical for an early train, but farther from the historic visitor core.

HARBIN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Taiping airport, Harbin station and Harbin West have different transfers. Allow extra time in winter weather.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use indoor breaks between short walks in cold weather. Metro and taxis help connect districts without long outdoor exposure.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Ice attractions and Sun Island are across the river from much of the old centre. Confirm event access and return transport before setting out.

TIME WELL SPENT

City foundations

Pair Central Street, Saint Sophia and a short river walk. Use another day for a museum and Lao Daowai.

TIME WELL SPENT

Seasonal extension

Dedicate a separate block to a confirmed winter event, or enjoy Sun Island in warmer weather. Keep the schedule flexible.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Shenyang

Liaoning / Northeast

An imperial chapter beyond Beijing.

Shenyang combines Qing-era landmarks with the story of an industrial metropolis. The imperial palace is compact compared with Beijing, leaving time for neighbourhood food and a museum. Outlying tombs and newer districts are best planned as separate blocks rather than a continuous walking route.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO May-June · September-October

Photo: Techyan | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

SHENYANG

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Shenyang Imperial Palace

Explore the courtyards and distinctive early Qing architecture.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Beiling Park

Allow time for the park and imperial tomb area.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Zhongjie

Walk the shopping streets and sample northeastern cooking.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Marshal Zhang's Mansion

A historic residential complex connected with northeastern modern history. Pair it with nearby old-centre sights.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Fuling Tomb

A Qing imperial tomb in the eastern city. Allow a separate transfer and walking time through the grounds.

Find on map

SHENYANG / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Liaoning Provincial Museum

A major provincial collection in the southern city. Check the exhibition programme and reservation process before travelling.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Xita neighbourhood

A district associated with Korean food and commercial life. Visit for a meal and street-level exploring rather than a single monument.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Industrial Museum of China

An introduction to industrial heritage in Tiexi. A different perspective from palaces and imperial tombs.

Find on map

SHENYANG

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Laobian-style dumplings

A local dumpling tradition with varied fillings. Ask about ingredients and order a manageable number of portions.

WHAT TO EAT

Guobaorou

Crisp sweet-sour pork common across the northeast. Share it with vegetables or a lighter soup.

WHAT TO EAT

Korean-influenced cold noodles

A useful option around Xita, with broth and toppings varying by restaurant. Check whether beef or egg is included.

YOUR BASE

Zhongjie / old centre

Convenient for the palace, shopping streets and local meals, but some areas stay busy late.

YOUR BASE

Taiyuan Street / Shenyang station

Good for transport and hotel choice, with a journey needed to the palace district.

SHENYANG

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Taoxian airport, Shenyang and Shenyang North railway stations are separate hubs. Check the exact station before leaving the hotel.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Metro journeys connect major districts; group nearby sights on foot. Winter conditions can slow transfers and shorten comfortable outdoor visits.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Fuling and Beiling are different tomb complexes. Pick one if time is limited rather than rushing both between museums.

TIME WELL SPENT

Imperial and modern

Pair the palace with Marshal Zhang's Mansion and an old-centre meal. Give Beiling another relaxed block.

TIME WELL SPENT

An extra day

Choose the provincial museum or Tiexi industrial history according to your interests, with dinner around Xita.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Dalian

Liaoning / Northeast

A northern port with room to breathe.

Dalian is a coastal city of plazas, hills and long waterfront roads. It suits a slower visit built around sea views and seafood rather than constant attraction entry. Historic central streets, southern coastal paths and distant resort areas need different transport plans.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO May-June · September-October

Photo: Fumihiko Ueno | CC BY 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

DALIAN

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Xinghai Square

Explore the broad seafront and surrounding coastal paths.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Binhai Road

Choose a walkable coastal section instead of covering the whole route.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Zhongshan Square

Look at the historic architecture and explore the nearby streets.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Laohutan coast

A coastal district with viewpoints and visitor attractions. Decide whether you want a waterfront walk or a ticketed attraction before travelling.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Bangchuidao

A landscaped coastal area with sea views. Check current public access and choose it for an unhurried outdoor visit.

Find on map

DALIAN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Donggang waterfront

A modern harbour-side district with broad promenades. Useful for an evening stroll when weather is pleasant.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Russian Style Street

A short historic-style commercial street near the centre. Pair it with nearby city architecture rather than making it a main-day destination.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Jinshitan

A full-day coastal excursion northeast of the centre. Choose a particular beach or geological landscape instead of trying to cover the whole area.

Find on map

DALIAN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Seafood

Fish, clams and other shellfish dominate many local menus. Confirm portion, weight and cooking charge before ordering.

WHAT TO EAT

Dalian menzi

Pan-fried starch jelly with sauce. A local snack whose dressing often includes sesame and garlic.

WHAT TO EAT

Seafood dumplings

Fish and mixed seafood fillings are common, sometimes with pork. Ask what is inside before ordering a large plate.

YOUR BASE

Zhongshan Square / central station

Good for architecture, dining and transport, with limited immediate beach access.

YOUR BASE

Xinghai Square

More waterfront space and newer hotels; travel time increases for old-centre sightseeing.

DALIAN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Zhoushuizi airport and Dalian or Dalian North railway stations have different city transfers. Confirm your departure hub.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use metro or vehicles between coastal districts, then walk a chosen section. Binhai Road is too long to treat as one casual stroll.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Jinshitan and Lushun are separate excursions in different directions. Select one based on your interests and available time.

TIME WELL SPENT

City and coast

Spend a day around Zhongshan Square and the central streets. Use another for Xinghai and a manageable Binhai Road section.

TIME WELL SPENT

A longer stay

Add Jinshitan for coastal scenery, keeping an indoor alternative if wind or rain changes the plan.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Dunhuang

Gansu / Northwest

Silk Road art at the edge of the desert.

Dunhuang is an oasis base for Buddhist art and desert landscapes. Its famous sights lie in different directions, and the western excursions involve long road days. Put cave reservations first, then arrange dunes and museums around the weather and the light.

SUGGESTED STAY 3 days

WHEN TO GO May-June · September-October

Photo: xiquinhosilva | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

DUNHUANG

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING
Mogao Caves

Book through the official visitor system and follow photography restrictions.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Crescent Lake

Explore the desert-edge landscape with sun protection and water.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Dunhuang Museum

Put the region's trade routes and Buddhist history into context.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Mingsha dunes

Sand landscapes adjoining the Crescent Lake area. Choose cooler hours and follow marked visitor routes; climbing sand is physically demanding.

Find on map

05 / DEDICATED OUTING
Yumen Pass

A full-day western excursion when linked with suitable nearby heritage stops. Long travel distances matter more than the time at the monument.

Find on map

DUNHUANG / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / DEDICATED OUTING

Yangguan Pass

A separate desert heritage outing southwest of town. Allow time for interpretation and avoid expecting a large intact ancient fortress.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Yardang National Geopark

A full-day desert excursion with wind-shaped formations. Confirm the organised internal route and return transfer.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shazhou market area

An evening district for food and souvenir browsing. Compare prices and ask before photographing vendors or craftwork.

Find on map

DUNHUANG

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Yellow noodles

A local wheat-noodle tradition, often served with meat or sauce. Ask about the accompanying dish and portion size.

WHAT TO EAT

Lamb dishes

Grilled and stewed lamb are common choices. Order vegetables or lighter sides to balance a meat-heavy meal.

WHAT TO EAT

Apricot drinks

A sweet local refreshment found around visitor areas. Check ingredients and whether it is freshly prepared or bottled.

YOUR BASE

Central Dunhuang / Shazhou

Convenient for meals and excursion pickups, with the widest choice for a short stay.

YOUR BASE

Crescent Lake area

Atmospheric for dune-focused visits but less convenient for town meals and some departures.

DUNHUANG

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Dunhuang airport and railway station serve the oasis. Liuyuan is a different, much more distant rail stop; check your ticket carefully.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use vehicles between the town, caves and dunes. Save pickup locations offline because sights are spread across open desert areas.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

The western passes and Yardang require a dedicated long day. Avoid planning a same-evening flight after an ambitious desert circuit.

TIME WELL SPENT

Art and landscape

Build one day around your Mogao reservation. Use another for the museum and dunes in suitable light and temperature.

TIME WELL SPENT

Western extension

Add a carefully planned pass-and-desert route only with a spare full day. Keep food, water and return logistics organised.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Lanzhou

Gansu / Northwest

A bowl of noodles and a walk beside the Yellow River.

Lanzhou follows the Yellow River between hills, making riverside walking a natural introduction. It is also a useful rail hub, but deserves more than a hurried bowl of noodles. The provincial museum provides context for journeys farther along the Silk Road.

SUGGESTED STAY 1-2 days

WHEN TO GO May-June · September-October

Photo: Megalizard29 | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

LANZHOU

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Zhongshan Bridge

Lanzhou / Gansu

Photo: Zhangzhugang | CC BY-SA 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yellow River waterfront

Walk by the river and cross Zhongshan Bridge.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Gansu Provincial Museum

Set aside time for Silk Road history and archaeological collections.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

White Pagoda Park

Explore the hillside paths for city and river views.

Find on map

LANZHOU / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Zhongshan Bridge

A historic river crossing and landmark beside the northern hills. Pair it with a short waterfront walk.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Waterwheel Garden

An introduction to traditional river-powered irrigation devices. A compact stop along a wider riverfront day.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Five Springs Mountain Park

A hillside park with temples and paths south of the centre. Allow for steps and choose a manageable loop.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Zhangye Road

A central pedestrian shopping area with access to nearby food streets. A useful evening stop rather than a major historic attraction.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Bingling Temple

A full-day excursion to Buddhist grottoes near the Liujiaxia area. Boat and road arrangements depend on current operations and conditions.

Find on map

LANZHOU

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Lanzhou beef noodles

Freshly pulled noodles in beef broth, often eaten for breakfast. Choose a noodle width and add chilli to taste.

WHAT TO EAT

Shouzhuayangrou

Simply prepared lamb served in pieces. A shared dish best paired with vegetables and bread.

WHAT TO EAT

Niangpi

Cool starch noodles with a tangy dressing. Check toppings and chilli before mixing the bowl.

YOUR BASE

Central riverfront

Good for bridge and promenade walks, with access to local food streets.

YOUR BASE

Lanzhou West station area

Useful for an early high-speed train but less atmospheric for a short city visit.

LANZHOU

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Zhongchuan airport is far from the centre. Lanzhou and Lanzhou West railway stations are different; match transfers to your actual ticket.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

The city is long and narrow. Combine rail transit or vehicles for east-west travel with walking on selected river sections.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Bingling Temple requires a separate day with checked transport arrangements. Labrang is better planned as an onward regional stay.

TIME WELL SPENT

A river-city pause

Visit the provincial museum, then choose a central river walk. Spend another morning around the bridge and White Pagoda Park.

TIME WELL SPENT

With more time

Add Bingling Temple if current transfers work, keeping a buffer before onward rail travel.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Xining

Qinghai / Northwest

A gateway to the plateau, with a culture of its own.

Xining brings together provincial museums, markets and living religious communities at the edge of the plateau. Use the city as a place to slow down before longer regional journeys. Qinghai Lake and monasteries outside the centre need their own transport plans.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO June-September

Photo: Andreas Gruschke | CC BY 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

XINING

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING

Kumbum Monastery

Visit respectfully and follow local rules on photography and access.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Qinghai Provincial Museum

Learn about the province's different landscapes and communities.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Dongguan Mosque area

Explore the neighbourhood and check visitor access before entering religious spaces.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Qinghai Tibetan Culture Museum

A specialised introduction to Tibetan cultural and artistic traditions. Check the exhibition location and allow focused viewing time.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Beishan area

A northern hillside religious and historic area. Check which sections are open and expect changes in level.

Find on map

XINING / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

People's Park

An everyday city park for a gentle walk and a pause between museum visits.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Mojia Street area

A central food-browsing district. Choose busy vendors preparing food to order and compare menus before sitting down.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Qinghai Lake

A full-day trip or longer regional stay. Choose a specific shore and route; the lake is too large for a casual add-on.

Find on map

XINING

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Qinghai yoghurt

A local dairy speciality often served plain with sugar separately. Ask about toppings and storage if buying takeaway.

WHAT TO EAT

Niangpi

Cool starch noodles with spicy or tangy seasoning. A common light meal or snack.

WHAT TO EAT

Hand-grabbed lamb

Simply prepared lamb in generous portions. Share it with bread and vegetable dishes.

YOUR BASE

Central Xining

Convenient for food and urban sightseeing, with more flexibility than staying beside an outlying attraction.

YOUR BASE

Railway station area

Practical for an early departure, but check street noise and access before booking.

XINING

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Caojiabao airport is outside Xining. Xining railway station is the key hub for many onward rail journeys.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use buses or taxis for spread-out city sights and walk within central areas. Allow a gentle pace rather than packing the arrival day.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Kumbum Monastery and Qinghai Lake are different excursions. Check weather, road conditions and current visitor arrangements before a long regional day.

TIME WELL SPENT

City context

Start with a museum and a short neighbourhood walk. Give Kumbum a separate outing with time to observe respectfully.

TIME WELL SPENT

A lake extension

Add a planned Qinghai Lake day or overnight route. Do not schedule an ambitious circuit immediately before a fixed departure.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Urumqi

Xinjiang / Northwest

A starting point for Xinjiang's vast landscapes.

Ürümqi is a gateway to Xinjiang, but the region is far too large to explore from one hotel. Spend time with museum collections and local food, then choose a specific mountain or onward journey. Confirm current visitor access and transport arrangements for each regional leg.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO May-June · September-October

Photo: Albertaont | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

URUMQI

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Heavenly Lake

Urumqi / Xinjiang

Photo: Caitriana Nicholson from ~ Beijing, ~ China | CC BY-SA 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Xinjiang Museum

Explore the collections for context on the region's histories.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hongshan Park

Walk the park for views across the city.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

International Grand Bazaar

Browse market stalls and compare prices before buying.

Find on map

URUMQI / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

People's Park

A central green space for an easy city walk. A useful pause between museums and food stops.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shuimogou Park

A park district with water and greenery outside the busiest centre. Allow time for the local transfer.

Find on map

06 / DEDICATED OUTING

Heavenly Lake

A full-day mountain excursion beyond the city. Weather, managed transport and walking determine how much you can see.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Southern Pastures

A separate countryside outing toward the Tian Shan foothills. Choose a defined destination and return arrangement rather than a vague pasture tour.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Tianshan Grand Canyon

A full-day scenic excursion with mountain landscapes. Check the specific visitor route, access and transport before departure.

Find on map

URUMQI

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Polo

Rice cooked with carrots and commonly lamb. A substantial meal; ask about meat and portion size.

WHAT TO EAT

Lagman

Pulled noodles with a vegetable-and-meat topping. Recipes and spice levels vary between restaurants.

WHAT TO EAT

Nang bread

Baked bread in many shapes and textures. Buy small quantities fresh and pair it with a meal rather than treating every type as identical.

YOUR BASE

Central museum / park districts

Useful for a city-focused stay and varied transport connections. Confirm accommodation arrangements directly.

YOUR BASE

Railway station area

Practical for an early onward journey but requires transfers for many central visitor stops.

URUMQI

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Confirm the airport name and terminal on your booking. Ürümqi station and Ürümqi South are separate rail locations.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use the metro where it serves your route and vehicles elsewhere. Keep destination names and hotel details saved in Chinese.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Heavenly Lake, the southern foothills and Turpan are separate journeys. Confirm current access, identification needs and return logistics with providers.

TIME WELL SPENT

A measured city start

Give the regional museum a generous visit, then explore a park and local food. Browse the bazaar area on a separate block.

TIME WELL SPENT

Choose one landscape

Add Heavenly Lake or a southern mountain excursion. Plan farther Xinjiang destinations as new travel legs with their own accommodation.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Changsha

Hunan / Central

A lively city with history behind the spice.

Changsha combines major archaeological collections with a lively evening food culture. Museum reservations, river geography and summer heat shape a good visit. Cross the river deliberately for Yuelu rather than repeatedly commuting between unrelated stops.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · October-November

Photo: Lectern | Public domain

Original photograph & licensing

CHANGSHA

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Orange Isle

Changsha / Hunan

Photo: EditQ | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hunan Museum

Plan around the museum's booking and opening arrangements.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yuelu Academy

Combine historic learning spaces with a walk at the foot of Yuelu Mountain.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Xiang River

Leave an evening for the waterfront and city food streets.

Find on map

CHANGSHA / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Orange Isle

A long island park in the Xiang River. Choose a realistic walking section and check local access conditions.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Yuelu Mountain

Wooded slopes, historic sites and viewpoints west of the river. Give the paths time and expect climbs.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Tianxin Pavilion

A historic landmark beside a surviving city-wall section. A compact cultural stop near the centre.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Taiping Street

A busy old-style shopping and snack street. Explore it with nearby lanes and expect crowds at popular hours.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA
Changsha Museum

Regional city history in the northern cultural district. An indoor alternative or complement to Hunan Museum.

Find on map

CHANGSHA

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Stinky tofu

Fermented tofu served freshly fried with sauce. Try a small portion first; toppings can be spicy.

WHAT TO EAT

Rice noodles

A local breakfast staple with varied meat and vegetable toppings. Specify chilli preferences before the bowl is dressed.

WHAT TO EAT

Steamed fish head with chopped chilli

A shared Hunan dish with a strong chilli flavour. Check fish size and price before ordering.

YOUR BASE

Wuyi Square area

Convenient for food and nightlife, but request a quiet room if sensitive to late noise.

YOUR BASE

Yuelu / university side

Good for western-bank sights and a slower stay, with river crossings for central nightlife.

CHANGSHA

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Huanghua airport and Changsha South high-speed station connect through different transport options. Changsha station is a separate central hub.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use metro journeys to cross between districts, then walk local clusters. Riverfront distances are longer than they appear on a simple map.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Shaoshan is a separate excursion. Do not add it after a full museum-and-mountain day.

TIME WELL SPENT

Collections and food

Build a day around Hunan Museum and keep the evening for a relaxed food walk. Avoid rushing multiple museum visits together.

TIME WELL SPENT

Across the river

Combine Yuelu Academy with a manageable mountain route. Give Orange Isle its own time if walking the longer sections.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Wuhan

Hubei / Central

Three towns, two rivers, countless breakfast stops.

Wuhan is a city of rivers and separate urban centres. Hankou streets, Wuchang landmarks and East Lake each deserve a coherent block of time. Breakfast is an essential part of the visit, while repeated cross-river transfers can quietly consume the day.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO March-April · October-November

Photo: MonsieurRoi | CC BY-SA 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

WUHAN

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Guiyuan Temple

Wuhan / Hubei

Photo: Gisling | CC BY 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yellow Crane Tower

Explore the landmark and nearby Wuchang streets.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hubei Provincial Museum

Give the archaeological collections an unhurried half-day.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

East Lake

Choose one lakeside area for walking or cycling.

Find on map

WUHAN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Guiyuan Temple

An active Buddhist complex in Hanyang. Allow a quiet visit and respect photography guidance.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hankou riverfront

Broad riverside public space and historic commercial streets nearby. Choose a section rather than walking the whole embankment.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Jianghan Road

A pedestrian shopping street with historic buildings. Pair it with nearby Hankou lanes and a meal.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Qingchuan Pavilion

A historic riverside site with views toward the Yangtze. A useful Hanyang stop rather than a cross-city detour.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Tanhualin

A compact district of old streets, cafes and cultural spaces in Wuchang. Explore at street level between larger landmarks.

Find on map

WUHAN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Hot dry noodles

Noodles coated in sesame-based sauce, commonly eaten for breakfast. Mix thoroughly and ask about chilli and toppings.

WHAT TO EAT

Doupi

A layered breakfast dish with glutinous rice and savoury fillings. Meat and egg are common ingredients.

WHAT TO EAT

Lotus-root soup

A regional comfort dish, often simmered with pork ribs. Confirm the broth if seeking a vegetarian meal.

YOUR BASE

Jianghan Road / Hankou

Good for breakfast, historic streets and evening river walks.

YOUR BASE

Wuchang / near East Lake

Useful for museums and lake time, with longer journeys to Hankou dining districts.

WUHAN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Wuhan, Hankou and Wuchang railway stations are different. Tianhe airport is another transfer; always check the exact arrival and departure hub.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use metro crossings between major districts. Walk within one riverbank or lake sector instead of zigzagging across the city.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

East Lake is extensive. Select a specific greenway or visitor area and arrange the return route before a long walk.

TIME WELL SPENT

Two sides of Wuhan

Use one day for the museum and a selected East Lake section. Spend another around Yellow Crane Tower and Wuchang streets.

TIME WELL SPENT

A food-focused extension

Start with breakfast in Hankou, then explore Jianghan Road and the riverfront without another cross-river transfer.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Zhengzhou

Henan / Central

A practical base for the heartland's deep history.

Zhengzhou is a practical transport hub with important archaeological context of its own. Give the provincial museum time before heading toward the more famous sights around Dengfeng or Luoyang. Those places need dedicated travel blocks rather than being treated as suburbs.

SUGGESTED STAY 2 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · September-November

Photo: Windmemories | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

ZHENGZHOU

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Henan Museum

Start with the collections to understand the region's ancient cultures.

Find on map

02 / DEDICATED OUTING

Shaolin Temple

Treat a visit near Dengfeng as a full-day excursion.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Erqi area

Explore the central city and sample local food.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shang Dynasty city-wall remains

Earthwork remains that reveal the city's much older past. Best appreciated with historical context rather than as a grand intact wall.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Zhengzhou Museum

Local history and archaeological collections. Check the branch and exhibitions before travelling across the city.

Find on map

ZHENGZHOU / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yellow River Scenic Area

A separate outing north of the centre for river landscapes and monuments. Allow for extensive grounds and local transfers.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Songyang Academy

A full-day Dengfeng excursion when paired with a nearby compatible stop. A historic academy at the foot of Mount Song.

Find on map

08 / DEDICATED OUTING

Mount Song

A dedicated mountain day around Dengfeng. Choose a particular route and avoid assuming all entrances are beside Shaolin.

Find on map

ZHENGZHOU

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Huimian

Broad noodles in a rich broth, commonly with lamb. A filling one-bowl introduction to Henan food.

WHAT TO EAT

Hulatang

A peppery breakfast soup with varied ingredients. Ask about meat and spice before ordering.

WHAT TO EAT

Guotie

Pan-fried dumplings with crisp bases. Fillings vary; order a small plate alongside soup or vegetables.

YOUR BASE

Erqi / central station

Convenient for older commercial streets and local food, but traffic can be busy.

YOUR BASE

Zhengdong / East station

Practical for high-speed rail and newer hotels, with transfers to older central sights.

ZHENGZHOU

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Xinzheng airport, Zhengzhou station and Zhengzhou East serve different arrivals. Match your hotel location to the actual rail ticket.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

The metro helps connect urban districts. Museum locations and older archaeological remains are not all in the same walking area.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Shaolin and Mount Song lie near Dengfeng. Arrange a dedicated excursion or overnight stay with a clear return plan.

TIME WELL SPENT

City context

Visit Henan Museum, then choose a central archaeological or neighbourhood walk. Keep time for a noodle meal.

TIME WELL SPENT

Dengfeng day

Choose Shaolin plus a realistic nearby stop, or a mountain route. Avoid combining a strenuous climb with a rushed evening train.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Fuzhou

Fujian / South

Courtyard stories under the banyan trees.

Fuzhou offers a slower Fujian city stay of lanes, banyan shade, temples and riverfront neighbourhoods. Its old centre and the districts across the Min River have different atmospheres. The coast, mountains and inland tea country should be planned as separate journeys.

SUGGESTED STAY 2 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · October-November

Photo: Listwisea f ord | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

FUZHOU

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Three Lanes and Seven Alleys

Explore the historic street layout and selected courtyard houses.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

West Lake Park

Take an easy walk through the lake gardens.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yantai Hill

Look for historic buildings, cafés and river views.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Fujian Museum

Provincial collections near the West Lake area. A useful introduction before exploring other parts of Fujian.

Find on map

05 / DEDICATED OUTING

Gushan

A hill-and-temple excursion east of the centre. Expect steps and leave time for the return journey.

Find on map

FUZHOU / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Xichan Temple

An active Buddhist temple with courtyards and architectural details. Keep the visit respectful and unhurried.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Shangxiahang

A restored historic commercial district with lanes and waterside spaces. Pair it with nearby riverfront exploring.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yu Mountain

A central hill with historic sites and shaded paths. A manageable contrast to the busy old commercial streets.

Find on map

FUZHOU

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Fuzhou fish balls

Fish-paste balls often enclosing a pork filling. Ask about the centre rather than assuming they contain only fish.

WHAT TO EAT

Rouyan

Meat-filled dumplings with an unusual thin wrapper made using pork. They are not a vegetarian wonton alternative.

WHAT TO EAT

Dingbianhu

A rice-batter soup with varied savoury additions. A good breakfast choice; seafood ingredients may be present.

YOUR BASE

Dongjiekou / old centre

Convenient for lanes, food and central sightseeing, with strong transport access.

YOUR BASE

Yantai Hill / Cangshan

Good for atmospheric streets and cafes, with river crossings for northern-city attractions.

FUZHOU

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Changle airport is outside the centre. Fuzhou and Fuzhou South railway stations are separate; check the station on your ticket.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use metro journeys between districts and walk selected historic neighbourhoods. Shaded breaks help in hot, humid weather.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Mount Wuyi and the tulou are separate regional destinations. Do not treat them as quick additions to a city day.

TIME WELL SPENT

Historic neighbourhoods

Pair Three Lanes and Seven Alleys with West Lake or the museum. Spend another day around Shangxiahang and Yantai Hill.

TIME WELL SPENT

A greener extension

Choose Gushan for a dedicated outdoor block, keeping a temple or museum alternative for poor weather.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Quanzhou

Fujian / South

A maritime trading city written in stone.

Quanzhou is a city of maritime connections and living religious traditions. Temples, a mosque, old trading streets and everyday food sit close together in the historic core. Take time to understand the sites instead of reducing them to a quick photo circuit.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · October-December

Photo: Tom@HK | CC BY 2.0

Original photograph & licensing

QUANZHOU

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Luoyang Bridge

Quanzhou / Fujian

Photo: N509FZ | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Kaiyuan Temple

Explore the temple grounds and look at the twin stone pagodas.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Qingjing Mosque

Learn about the city's maritime connections and respect site access rules.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

West Street

Walk the old streets and look for everyday craft and food traditions.

Find on map

QUANZHOU / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Tianhou Temple

A temple associated with the sea goddess Mazu and maritime life. Observe worship respectfully and look for the architectural details.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Quanzhou Maritime Museum

Context for the city's trading networks and religious diversity. A strong complement to walking the historic centre.

Find on map

06 / DEDICATED OUTING

Qingyuan Mountain

A hill excursion with the famous Laozi stone figure and walking routes. Give it a separate half-day or longer.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Luoyang Bridge

A historic stone bridge north of the centre. A separate transfer makes it better suited to an unhurried extra day.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Guanyue Temple

A busy active temple near the historic core. Visit with consideration for worshippers and avoid blocking ritual spaces.

Find on map

QUANZHOU

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Mianxianhu

A fine-noodle soup with selectable additions. Meat, seafood and offal toppings vary between stalls.

WHAT TO EAT

Quanzhou zongzi

Glutinous-rice parcels commonly filled with meat and other savoury ingredients. A substantial snack rather than a light bite.

WHAT TO EAT

Ginger duck

Duck cooked with plenty of ginger, usually shared. Check the portion size before ordering for a small group.

YOUR BASE

West Street / old centre

Best for early and evening walks, but lanes may limit vehicle access and rooms can be noisy.

YOUR BASE

Fengze

More modern hotels and convenient city transfers, with a journey needed for historic-core wandering.

QUANZHOU

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Jinjiang airport is outside the old centre. Quanzhou railway stations serve different routes, so use the exact name on your ticket.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Walk the historic core and use buses or taxis for outlying sights. Build breaks into hot-weather temple and street visits.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Qingyuan Mountain, Luoyang Bridge and coastal villages are separate outings. Avoid adding all of them to a full old-city day.

TIME WELL SPENT

Maritime city

Pair Kaiyuan and West Street, then use another block for Qingjing Mosque, nearby temples and local food.

TIME WELL SPENT

Beyond the lanes

Choose the Maritime Museum plus a short central walk, or a separate Qingyuan Mountain outing.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Sanya

Hainan / South

A few days where the itinerary can wait.

Sanya is a collection of bays with different hotel styles and transfer distances. Choose your base around how you want to spend most days: accessible city dining, resort time or a quieter beach setting. A good beach holiday leaves room for weather rather than filling every day with attractions.

SUGGESTED STAY 3-5 days

WHEN TO GO November-April

Photo: Anna Frodesiak | CC0

Original photograph & licensing

SANYA

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yalong Bay

Choose a beach base suited to your budget and preferred pace.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Dadonghai

Combine time by the sea with nearby dining.

Find on map

03 / DEDICATED OUTING

Nanshan

Plan a separate visit to the Buddhist cultural site west of the city.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Sanya Bay

A long urban coastline suited to evening walks. Choose a section near your base instead of trying to cover the whole bay.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Haitang Bay

A resort-focused coast farther from the urban centre. Good for hotel time; do not assume every stretch is suitable for swimming.

Find on map

SANYA / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / DEDICATED OUTING

Wuzhizhou Island

A separate island day trip with boat and activity arrangements. Weather can affect access and the experience.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Luhuitou

A hilltop park with views over the city and bays. Choose cooler hours and allow for the uphill approach.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Tianya Haijiao

A coastal landmark park west of the city. Pair it only with nearby plans rather than a cross-city beach circuit.

Find on map

SANYA

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Hainan chicken

Simply prepared chicken served with rice or side dishes. Sauces vary and can be served separately.

WHAT TO EAT

Coconut chicken hotpot

A shared chicken broth with coconut flavour. Follow the restaurant's cooking instructions before eating ingredients.

WHAT TO EAT

Qingbuliang

A sweet dessert with assorted beans, fruit and other toppings, often in coconut milk. Check the ingredients before ordering.

YOUR BASE

Dadonghai / urban Sanya

Convenient for restaurants and shorter city transfers, with a busier beach atmosphere.

YOUR BASE

Yalong Bay / Haitang Bay

Resort-oriented stays with more time spent at the hotel. Check the actual beach conditions and transfer distances.

SANYA

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Phoenix airport and Sanya railway station require different transfers to each bay. Confirm the hotel's district before judging travel time.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use vehicles between bays and walk locally. Moving repeatedly between resort areas can consume much of a day.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Island trips and western coastal attractions need separate planning. Follow local swimming flags and weather guidance rather than assuming all beaches are equivalent.

TIME WELL SPENT

A relaxed first stay

Keep the arrival day at your chosen bay. Add Luhuitou or a city meal on another day without changing beaches repeatedly.

TIME WELL SPENT

Choose one outing

Select Nanshan, Tianya Haijiao or an island trip according to your interests, and retain a weather-flexible resort day.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Haikou

Hainan / South

Arcaded streets and a slower island introduction.

Haikou is an urban introduction to Hainan, with arcaded streets, neighbourhood breakfast and provincial history. It offers a different experience from Sanya's resort bays. Use it for cultural walks and selected coastal or volcanic excursions rather than expecting every hotel to be a beach retreat.

SUGGESTED STAY 2 days

WHEN TO GO November-April

Photo: Yolanda Yao | CC BY-SA 4.0

Original photograph & licensing

HAIKOU

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Temple of Five Lords

Haikou / Hainan

Photo: Rolfmueller | CC BY-SA 3.0

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Qilou Old Street

Walk the historic arcades and stop for coffee or snacks.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hainan Museum

Learn about the island beyond its beaches.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Holiday Beach

Leave a relaxed afternoon for the waterfront.

Find on map

HAIKOU / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Temple of Five Lords

A historic complex linked with officials exiled to Hainan. A compact cultural visit near other southern-city sites.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Qiongtai Academy

A traditional academy in the older Qiongshan area. Pair it with nearby heritage stops rather than a separate cross-city journey.

Find on map

06 / DEDICATED OUTING

Haikou volcanic landscape

A full-day or generous half-day excursion southwest of the city. Expect outdoor walking and choose a defined visitor route.

Find on map

07 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Wanlu Park

A large urban green space near the coast. Useful for a gentle walk in cooler hours.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Hai Rui's Tomb

A historic memorial site associated with the Ming official. A focused stop for visitors interested in Hainan's cultural history.

Find on map

HAIKOU

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Hainan rice noodles

Local rice noodles with savoury toppings and dressing. Seafood and meat additions vary by shop.

WHAT TO EAT

Laoba tea

An everyday tea-house tradition with small snacks and bakery items. Sit for a while rather than treating it as takeaway coffee.

WHAT TO EAT

Wenchang chicken

A Hainan speciality often served simply with dipping sauces. Ask about portion size and accompaniments.

YOUR BASE

Qilou / old centre

Good for arcaded streets and local food, though older buildings may have varied room standards.

YOUR BASE

Wanlu Park / coastal city area

More contemporary hotels and open space, with transfers needed for old-town meals.

HAIKOU

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Meilan airport connects with island rail services. Haikou East and Haikou station are different; the latter is farther west.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use walking within the old streets and buses or taxis for spread-out sights. Heat and rain make midday breaks useful.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

The volcanic area and mangrove excursions need dedicated transfers. Sanya is a separate stay or rail journey rather than an urban side trip.

TIME WELL SPENT

City introduction

Explore Qilou streets and a tea house, then use another block for Hainan Museum and the Qiongshan heritage area.

TIME WELL SPENT

Outdoor extension

Choose the volcanic landscape or a coastal park day according to weather. Keep the evening free for local food.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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Wuyishan

Fujian / South

Tea paths and a river threaded through red cliffs.

Wuyishan is about the relationship between river, cliffs and tea. Base yourself for the scenic area rather than assuming the city centre is the attraction. Choose a few complementary routes and leave space for a tea session instead of attempting every climb.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO April-June · September-November

Photo: | CC BY 2.5 cn

Original photograph & licensing

WUYISHAN

Places worth your time.

A CLOSER LOOK

Nine Bend River

Wuyishan / Fujian

Photo: | CC BY 2.5 cn

Original photograph & licensing

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / DEDICATED OUTING

Nine Bend River

Check official rafting availability before building the day around it.

Find on map

02 / DEDICATED OUTING

Tianyou Peak

Allow for steps, weather and time to enjoy the views.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Wuyi tea country

Explore tea-growing scenery and clarify tasting or purchase prices.

Find on map

WUYISHAN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Dahongpao tea trail

A walking area associated with the famous rock-tea tradition. Use it to understand the landscape as well as taste the tea.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Wuyi Palace

A cultural area near the river and scenic routes. A gentler stop to balance a day with a steep climb.

Find on map

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Water Curtain Cave area

A separate scenic walking sector with cliffs and tea-country surroundings. Check route conditions and allow time for the return connection.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Roaring Tiger Rock

A steep scenic route for walkers comfortable with stairs. Choose it as an alternative climb rather than stacking it after Tianyou.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Yixiantian

A narrow rock passage in the scenic area. Consider crowding, confined space and slippery steps before including it.

Find on map

WUYISHAN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Wuyi rock tea

Locally associated oolong teas vary widely in taste and price. Agree on tasting and purchase terms before a long session.

WHAT TO EAT

Smoked goose

A regional speciality with a strong flavour, often served with chilli. Ask about spice level before ordering.

WHAT TO EAT

Bamboo-shoot dishes

Seasonal shoots appear in local cooking, often with meat. Confirm the preparation if you prefer a lighter or meat-free dish.

YOUR BASE

Sangu resort area

A practical visitor base with restaurants and access toward the scenic entrances.

YOUR BASE

Wuyishan urban centre

Useful for city services, but adds transfers if every day is focused on the scenic area.

WUYISHAN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Check the exact railway station, such as Nanping City or Wuyishan North, and arrange the onward transfer to your base.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

The scenic area combines managed transport and walking. Separate entrances, climbs and raft departure points need a planned sequence.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Rafting is weather- and operation-dependent. Keep a land-based alternative and confirm the correct departure point and time.

TIME WELL SPENT

River and cliffs

Give Tianyou a dedicated walking block. Put the Nine Bend River on a separately confirmed slot rather than rushing between the two.

TIME WELL SPENT

Tea-country day

Choose one tea-country walk and an unhurried tasting. Add another climb only if weather and energy make it worthwhile.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

TravelChinaGuide · Mount Wuyi

Jingdezhen

Jiangxi / East

A city made by clay, fire, and human hands.

Jingdezhen is most rewarding when you follow the making of porcelain, not just the finished objects. Museums give context; workshops and markets reveal contemporary practice. Leave room in the itinerary for browsing and conversations, and plan packing before buying fragile pieces.

SUGGESTED STAY 2-3 days

WHEN TO GO March-May · September-November

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JINGDEZHEN

Places worth your time.

A starting collection, not a single-day checklist. Dedicated outings need their own travel time.

01 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Imperial Kiln Museum

Explore ceramic history and the museum's distinctive architecture.

Find on map

02 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Taoxichuan

Visit the former industrial area's galleries, studios and shops.

Find on map

03 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Ceramic workshops

Arrange a hands-on session and confirm firing and shipping times before paying.

Find on map

04 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

China Ceramics Museum

A broad introduction to ceramic history and technique. Useful before shopping, so shapes and glazes have more meaning.

Find on map

05 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Ancient Kiln Folk Customs Museum

Kiln structures and craft interpretation in a dedicated visitor setting. Check which demonstrations are actually scheduled.

Find on map

JINGDEZHEN / CONTINUED

Places worth your time.

06 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Sanbao village

A spread-out ceramics and creative district outside the centre. Plan local transfers and confirm workshop visits in advance.

Find on map

07 / DEDICATED OUTING

Yaoli

A full-day village excursion for historic streets and a greener landscape. It requires a separate road journey from central Jingdezhen.

Find on map

08 / CITY & LOCAL AREA

Fuliang Ancient County Office

A heritage outing north of the city that offers context beyond ceramics. Combine only with geographically compatible stops.

Find on map

JINGDEZHEN

At the table. Where to stay.

WHAT TO EAT

Jiaozi ba

A local snack with a rice-based wrapper and savoury fillings. Ask about meat and chilli before choosing a portion.

WHAT TO EAT

Lengfen

Cool starch noodles with seasoning. A simple snack whose chilli level and toppings vary.

WHAT TO EAT

Jiangxi-style home cooking

Local meals often feature rice, vegetables and strongly seasoned meat or fish. Request mild preparation early if needed.

YOUR BASE

Imperial kiln / central city

Good for museum access and older streets, with a range of small hotels.

YOUR BASE

Taoxichuan / creative districts

Useful for contemporary ceramics and evening browsing. Check actual market dates rather than assuming stalls operate every night.

JINGDEZHEN

The practical chapter.

TRANSPORT

Arriving

Jingdezhen North station and Luojia airport serve arrivals outside the main museum streets. Confirm your accommodation's exact district.

TRANSPORT

Getting around

Use vehicles between museum and workshop districts, then walk locally. Sanbao is spread out and is not one compact indoor market.

TRANSPORT

Beyond the centre

Yaoli needs its own excursion day. For workshop visits, confirm language, duration, firing and shipping arrangements before paying.

TIME WELL SPENT

From history to making

Visit the ceramics museum before the imperial kiln area. Use another day for a confirmed workshop and Taoxichuan browsing.

TIME WELL SPENT

A third day

Choose Sanbao for contemporary studios or Yaoli for village scenery. Keep time to inspect, pack and document any purchases.

SOURCES & UPDATES

Original editorial notes. References accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm current access, reservations and services with operators before booking.

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